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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Wednesday, November 15, 2023

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Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	8h 21m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-UecTmFaP24
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:05:15] meeting to order. I'll note that I have approved the remote participation of Mr. Bill Hansen under the board bylaws and 2.2-3708.3 of the Code of Virginia because his principal residence is more than 60 miles from our meeting location today. I would like to sincerely thank the board for their engagement over the past several weeks. We have been working on some really important topics and um we will be discussing those today we have additionally scheduled english language arts

[00:05:51] standards listening sessions and launching the community list listening sessions excuse me for our accountability and accreditation nora so dr coons could you please share the dates of those eight regional sessions with us if you have them before you maybe or we can hold on as is customary with this board can we please begin our meeting with amendment of silence

[00:06:24] followed by the pledge of allegiance i pledge allegiance to the flag of the united states of of America, and to the Republic for which it stands for nations are not indisible for liberty and justice for all.

[00:07:00] Okay, before we approve the agenda as presented, I would like to ask that we move item E, or do you want to go ahead?

[00:07:20] item e and item h ahead of a b c d um e and h so that would be nominations to fill vacancies on board of education advisory committees and then first and final review of programmatic guidelines for

career and tech education so if we can move those ahead of a and b mr rotherham additional could we also move the lab school approval so we could have that reflected in

[00:08:00] when we get to the annual report discussion because that's a consequential action we are trying to make sure that the presenters for lab school can come at that time yep so if if that's possible we would go ahead and move that one as well so given given that and that would be item which one mr rotherham um i believe that is uh item f and g f and g okay we're checking on f and g yes i think if i were moving before item b a is consent agenda oh i'm sorry thank you

[00:08:32] i'm moving in my head so let's move those before e and h possibly f and j before item b would anybody like to make that motion i'm sorry e and h possibly f and g before b all those in favor if i may first i'd just like to note my objection for the record i've already shared it with my fellow board members and the superintendent but just for the record i object

[00:09:11] to having public comment at the end of the day rather than at the beginning of the day because it deprives the public of opportunity to comment before we vote on our business items and i also object for the record as i've shared with all of you all to canceling tomorrow's uh business meeting in light of our work schedule okay mr rotherham i concur with the concern on public comment but i'd ask can we move a discussion of that to the discussion of current issues uh later in the meetings i do think that's worth worthy of discussing certainly all those in

[00:09:46] favor of making the um amendments to the agenda aye aye any opposed all right okay back to you you Dr. Goons? Yes, we are working to make sure that we have strong accountability listening stakeholder sessions as the board has done a lot of work and put forward a Nora to move forward with conversations about changing the accountability and accreditation system. We are now at the point where we can engage stakeholders. Given the calendar of events, we are still trying to

[00:10:22] finalize region one we had originally had region one scheduled but that is scheduled at the same time as the hunt education legislative institute so we are working for another date for region one and we'll get back with the board as soon as we um get a tentative date and confirm with the board members who said they could come to the earlier date if they can come to the second date um the second region two meeting is december 13th and that is at chesapeake public schools region three

[00:10:53] is december 1st and that is at stafford public schools region four is at the jmu science and technology campus in prince william county region five is in bedford county schools region six is in roanoke city schools on november 27th region 7 is our first meeting next monday november 20th at the southwest higher ed center and the region 8 meeting is december 14th in greensville county

[00:11:30] we will post those make sure they are publicly noticed currently but we'll post those on the board of education website and make sure that everyone has communication they will also go out in the newsletter and went out to superintendents last night in an email to them as well so we want to make sure those are well published well communicated and are working with the regions to create local communications to make sure that we get as much public engagement as possible thank you to the board for working very quickly to help us get those scheduled in the midst of all the

[00:12:03] holidays that are happening what was the date of bedford region five my apologies december 7th any Allison McWilliams: Any other comments or questions on those dates before we move ahead, and we will have those obviously listed very quickly for us all to be able to see those and move forward.

[00:12:29] Allison McWilliams: So I would like to move to the next item on our agenda, which is the approval of minutes staffs provided the members of the board with the draft minutes before the meeting is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented to the board. second okay discussion miss holton i did make a suggested amendment to staff and i'm not sure whether that's yet been incorporated into the draft could we get clarity on that the staff reviewed the video and didn't agree with the amendment so it's not incorporated in the minutes and when we get to the then i'd like to make a motion uh i guess there's already a motion on the

[00:13:09] table so in the context of discussion may i raise my suggestion sure uh i don't remember if i copied this so i apologize if i didn't but i uh my recollection is that uh when i asked uh during our discussion uh about the special ed i asked dr coons if she could give us an updated rubric showing how the i teach special ed courses that they've now given us curricula for how they match

[00:13:43] up to the regulatory requirements as we had for the other I teach courses back in the spring and if you remember there was a document that was withheld from us at the march meeting that showed that the prior I teach curricula did not match the regulatory requirements and so I asked that the staff do an updated rubric showing us how the new course content information does meet that requirement and it was my understanding that dr coon said yes she would have the staff supply that to us and i asked that the minutes reflect that i said that in a long-winded way i said it more

[00:14:19] concisely in my email and can draw that up shortly if that would be helpful as for language okay as the motion is on the table um is there any other discussion before we vote to approve the minutes as presented by staff so madam president what would be the right procedural mechanism if i want to ask that that additional language be added and have the board consider that i don't jim

[00:14:53] i apologize i was doing other work yeah we would approve them there is a motion on the table to approve the minutes as presented sure substitute so i'd like to make a substitute motion if i may to approve the minutes with this addition uh under discussion of current issues i would amend the language dr coons stated to dr coons responded affirmatively to miss holton's

[00:15:29] request and stated and i made the motion and i think i have to accept the revision to the motion is that right no she has but it's a substitute motion which now gets voted on and it needs a second it does need a second a second so we can discuss and i don't mean to make a big deal about what was or wasn't said but i would love the rubric so perhaps if that's something that dr or Coons can address prospectively, then that solves the minutes. The minutes problem could be

[00:16:08] moot. Madam President, I don't think we have to amend the minutes to reflect that. If that's a request, you can put that request in at any time. It's an issue as to whether or not your version is in conflict with the staff as they review the tape. So you can ask it at any point, but I don't think we need to amend the minutes for that purpose. Well, I would be asking to remove the minutes because it's my understanding that Dr. Koons made that commitment last meeting,

[00:16:42] but I agree that we don't need to amend the minutes. If perhaps Dr. Koons can solve this, would staff be amenable to doing an updated rubric going forward, showing how the I-Teach curriculum matches the regulatory requirements as they did for all the other I-Teach course content just doing the same thing for special ed now that we've got the new information from i teach president i think it's certain i would object to making i think it's more than just changing the minutes i think at this point we need to approve the object to we have to vote on

[00:17:20] the second promotion i object to that amendment of the the minutes um and i think we should just move forward with up or down whether or not as a board we will approve that recommendation and then move forward vote and voting on the original minutes as approved. So I object to Mrs. Holton's amendment. Which can be reflected in our vote on the substitute motion. So is there any other discussion before we vote on the substitute motion to amend the minutes? This is simply a vote as to

[00:17:56] whether or not we're going to amend the minutes that Mrs. Holton. Right. In my discussion, I sound opposed to it. I think we should, we have to vote up or down on the amendment and then vote on the original minutes as presented. Right. Mr. Rotherham. This is a question which I'd be happy to phrase as an amendment. Can we defer approving the minutes until we can resolve? Because if we can't, if we can't resolve this issue of what's in the minutes, we can at least get an answer to the I teach question. It seems like, it seems like we're getting hung up on a procedural issue. We just, we need an answer on the I teach question. We're getting hung up on like a bureaucratic way

[00:18:34] to do that rather than just so right now the minutes are at hand and we need to get over that issue that is how to solve it is in another situation altogether so at this point unless there's anybody else that would like to make a comment about the sub uh substitute motion made by miss holton mr rotherham yeah i'm not comfortable voting on it because at my advanced stage i can't remember what happened and so i'm not comfortable saying whether i agree or disagree because i honestly can't remember without a chance to go back and look anyone else yes and

[00:19:09] sometimes that is the case and um the proper perhaps be just to abstain if you're just moving forward anyone else okay this vote is on miss holton's substitute motion to amend the minutes as she's requested miss holton aye dr siebert abstain mr hansen no miss ashton no dr northern mr certifan no mr rotherham stand and chair votes no okay now um this motion is to approve

[00:19:49] we need a motion to approve the minutes as presented so move okay miss holton no dr siebert hi mr hansen all right miss ashton hi dr northern mr sturdifant hi mr rotherham hi and chair votes aye okay um and we will move into a very special uh recognition at this point of family engagement month we have a resolution regarding family engagement month miss ashton

[00:20:25] will take the podium for us this morning good morning um happy november can't believe it's november already um i'm here on behalf of the board for a resolution to commemorate november 2023 as family engagement in education month Again, good morning. I am pleased to present this morning the board's resolution to commemorate November as Family Engagement in Education Month.

[00:20:59] The board recognizes the strengthening relationships between parents, schools, educators, and communities is critical in meeting the needs of Virginia's commitment to high expectations and excellence for all students. The board encourages schools to plan for ongoing family engagement and assist families in learning effective ways to engage in their children's education. The board and department are committed to helping develop innovative ways of collaboration with families to ensure every parent feels valued

[00:21:33] and respected to benefit their child's learning and achievement. To promote effective family engagement the board and department will continue its efforts to ensure that parents and educators know a child's success and challenges challenge areas by providing honest timely accurate and actionable information family engagement and education month reminds us that children are our present and our future of our beloved commonwealth and they deserve an excellent

[00:22:09] education that will prepare them to thrive throughout their academic career and beyond. Please join me in recognizing November as Family Engagement in Education Month in the Commonwealth. Madam President, I would like to make a motion to adopt this resolution.

[00:22:26] Is there a second? Second. Okay, all those in favor? Aye. Okay, so most of you know that Governor Yunkin made a proclamation on November 1st, recognizing november's family engagement month in education month and i'm happy that the board and the department are united with the governor in recognizing the importance of strong partnerships between families and schools and now we have an additional recognition recognition of our 2023

[00:23:00] milken educator dr northern would you help us recognize our milken educator of the year please I would love to. This is honestly the most important thing. I don't care what any other people say. It's the most important thing. We're going to do today, I have the pleasure day of recognizing Pamela Stepko. She's going to come up in a minute, but I'm going to say a bunch of really good things about her first. She is Virginia's 2022 Milken Educator Award winner. The Milken Educator Award is established by the Milken Family Foundation. It recognizes

[00:23:39] early to mid-career educators possessing exceptional educational talent and exemplary educational leadership who are engaging, motivating, and impactful not only to their students but their colleagues and the community. Pamela possesses all of those qualities in full. A math interventionist at Virginia's Cumberland Elementary School, Pamela helps students build confidence in the classroom and beyond determined to reach every child she motivates and encourages students by setting

[00:24:12] clear expectations and i'll add high expectations for their success she writes problems on the windows uh so students can see both the math and the world beyond and sets math content to music don't we love that to increase retention she looks at data to determine next steps and develops targeted instruction for every child not an easy task sorry i've got all my little um you know comments here on the side um she determines that every student who walks through her door will learn math realize their importance and find their voice cumberland elementary school had just entered

[00:24:51] focus school status when pamela arrived but due in part to her contributions the math scores have rose 30 percentage points wowza that is a big increase uh pamela has taught pre-k as well as second and third grade she served as an assistant principal at cumberland elementary before stepping into her current role which she sought out after expanding her family as administrator she has had a significant positive impact on the school community at the onset of the pandemic to

[00:25:27] ensure access to learning materials for students who lacked reliable internet service at home she created a system using qr codes okay do any of us know how to do that other than pamela created qr codes so families could use their cell phones to access videos and handouts she led the school through the creation of rubrics to guide teachers on the integration of virginia's five C's critical thinking creative thinking communication collaboration and citizenship into the curriculum sharing the school's profile of a graduate at the 2021 Virginia ASCD conference

[00:26:06] she earned a bachelor's in nk6 liberal studies in 2007 a master's of education and administration and supervision in 2016 from longwood university and the board is very pleased very pleased to be given the opportunity to recognize pamela and we appreciate her joining us today um and then you're going to hear more good stuff um i'm going to call dr coons up from for some additional comments about

[00:26:35] miss stepco i think i'm going to go off script as well yeah absolutely first virginia joined the millican educator awards program in 1999 and since then over a million dollars have been awarded to awesome amazing super exceptional educators like missisepco in the state of virginia the awards provide recognition and unrestricted financial awards to exceptional amazing wonderful virginia educators who are advancing excellence rigor and understanding in our virginia schools this past

[00:27:14] april pamela was welcomed to the millican's national network of excellence at the millican educator awards forum in los angeles where she participated in panels and roundtables with other millican educators across the nation this year the millican family foundation is presenting up to 75 millican educator awards across the country we appreciated our continued partnership with the millican educator awards program and we look forward to many more awesome surprise announcements

[00:27:47] that elevate educators across Virginia. I am so excited that Pamela's parents Robert and Janet Bowen are here as well as Superfly Superintendent Chip Jones, Cumberland Schools, amazing advocate for Cumberland County and serves on our superintendent task force and a variety of all kinds of other things to lead across the state of virginia and mrs jimmy jills who also serves on our regional principals um advisory council and does some amazing advocacy work for

[00:28:26] educators across the state so i i can't um leave them out of this awesomeness because they are doing great work in cumberland county and the teachers and staff at cumberland county i was so excited i got to visit cumberland county two weeks ago and had these amazing ambassadors lead us through the halls and talk about their educators the incredible work they're doing and then they took me down this collaboration hall where you know you go into some schools and there's white halls some cute pictures on the wall maybe some student work they had put whiteboards

[00:29:02] and seats and then at the end of this collaboration hall one of the ambassadors who said nothing the entire time we were walking around it's like no you gotta do math with us and took me up to mrs stepko's wall and what the two of them walked two two ambassadors walked me through how mrs stepko was helping them understand mathematics on the walls and it was so powerful to hear students talking about your work and your impact and not like high school students these are small children talking about the impact that you have mrs stepko so i am so incredibly blessed first

[00:29:37] to honor you with the millenkin award with the board but also to thank you because it was so powerful to hear students that you have impacted in your work in cumberland elementary so thank you very much i would love to have you speak about your work now good morning and thank you all for this recognition it's an honor to join you today uh growing up around educators i always knew i

[00:30:12] wanted to be a teacher i myself was a struggling learner in reading and in math throughout my school years it wasn't until i was placed in the hands of one very determined veteran teacher that i began to see success she was one who would swarm around the room looking over top of my shoulder giving feedback and showing me step by step how to solve not always did she praise as this was not in her personality but sometimes would catch a glimpse i would catch a glimpse of her warm smile when she knew that i have achieved achieved mastery through her perseverance and her

[00:30:49] unwillingness to accept failure she brought the clarity and the confidence that i needed to be successful what i didn't know is that i would carry forward her determination and perseverance within my own teaching career and share the same vision that all students can succeed reflecting back on the day that i received the milk and educator award and the day after as i was still trying to process what had

happened, the best way that I can describe is my brain being flooded with a thousand memories of the past 16 years of teaching children. A flashback of children who

[00:31:27] would enter my classroom coming from loving families who were well-fed, well-dressed, and supported educationally at home. But most of all, a flashback of children who entered my classroom, carrying with them a book bag full of struggles daily. Children of poverty, children who had not eaten since the school day before, children who had been retained, children who were reading two or three grade levels below, children that came from situations that were the unthinkable.

[00:31:59] Flooding my brain were the memories of the hard work and the determination from myself and from my students over those years. The grit and the endurance that it took for each student to be the very best version of themselves. It was a flashback of success, celebration, high-fiving in the air, jumping for joy, saying, you did it. It was a flashback of all of the crazy things that it took for each child to make a connection to instruction. From standing on a desk to writing on walls to

[00:32:31] telling a fairy tale story, fairy tale math story, the teaching like your hair was on fire every day. It was the flashback of continuing to share the message. They can do it. It's going to happen. Trust me. The phone calls home to families celebrating growth and achievement and the moments of reflection when trying to determine the best way to pivot to reach the next student.

[00:32:56] All of the years where it took finding what it was for each child to be successful. The strategic, intentional plan designed for each individual student. It has been an absolute hard 16 years, but it has been the most rewarding.

[00:33:15] I strive to give my students the same resilience that my teacher gave me. As a Milken educator, I look forward to the opportunities to network with the amazing educators across the nation, continue to learn and grow, and to seek daily to be 10% bolder. My advice to educators entering or continuing this profession is to continue to have high expectations for all students.

[00:33:41] Our students become what they hear and what you believe. What we expose them to sets the foundation for learning and determines their pathway for success. Do the hard. In those hard days, find what it is that fuels your focus and provides clarity, regrounding you to be your best. Every experience and challenge is a learning opportunity. It is within the hard situations that we truly learn and grow. Surround yourself with a positive, solution-driven network that will grow and support you along your journey. Always be ready to pivot. When you are not getting the

[00:34:18] outcomes that align to your purpose, push the pause button. Reflect, recalibrate, and pivot. Pivot in the direction that is going to build momentum and a positive change. And lastly, run. Run hard when you are running towards a vision fueled by a purpose, ignited by your passion.

[00:34:39] Keep going until you have achieved what you know is right for children. Be persistent, be courageous, and know that you have the ability and the power to make a difference in education. Thank you all for welcoming me today.

[00:34:56] It is an honor to be here.

[00:34:57] Hey, you guys can hear me, maybe I should come closer to the microphone, but we wanted to present you with your official award here today. And I just wanted to say how blessed you are to have your

parents here with you, because one of the things that you spoke about really got to me is how important relationships are.

[00:35:39] and in particular in our smaller communities like cumberland county that is the heart the heart of what you do every day is the relationships you have with your students with your um the teachers and the staff that you work with and most importantly with your students parents so you are so deserving of this and we are so proud of you

[00:36:16] take a picture you guys want to come down perfect you want to leave your stuff special award um taller people in the back shorter people in the front so that brings you down okay that's the resolution too you kind of want to help her down a little bit i don't know are we staying up tim how do you want us so some people down here some people at the top so yeah and we would love if your parents would join us too for a picture okay yeah but let's get one alone and then have

[00:36:54] them join us okay are they close enough we need to back up we need to scoot in okay

[00:37:17] okay please come on up

[00:37:25] very words to them stand on either side of you thank you so much

[00:38:24] Okay, so Dr. Siebert, are you going to move us into our closed session?

[00:38:52] Absolutely. Before we do that, Madam Press, can we entertain a motion? You did a nice job. Dr. Coons did a very nice job, but I'd like to edit a motion that Dr. does all recognitions going forward it's the important stuff that's why we're all here though that teaching and those kids so anyway thank you okay so i moved at the virginia board of education convene into a closed meeting for the following purposes consultation with legal counsel and briefings by staff members and consultants pertaining to the action to actual or probable

[00:39:27] litigation pursuant to Section 2.2.3711 of the Code of Virginia, consultation with counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring provision of legal advice pursuant to 2.2.3711 of the Code of Virginia, and discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion and subdivision 11 of 22 of 2.2 37 0 5.2 pursuant to 2.2 37 11 a 40 of the code of virginia and that

[00:40:04] legal counsel to the virginia board of education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's considerations matter participate in the closed meeting fair second second all those in favor

[00:40:17] aye me opposed okay we are now in closed session i move to certify that we convene today in closed

[02:44:10] meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes that there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of that departure in his or her judgment that has taken

[02:44:46] place a statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes okay miss holton yeah i need a second on that uh miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr

certifan mr rotherham hi and chair votes aye okay all right in case number one the chair will entertain a motion to suspend the license of karen lynn sutherland james for a period of five

[02:45:24] years second or motion second okay miss holton aye dr siebert hi mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hey mr sturdifant hey mr rotherham and chair votes i in the case in case number two the chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to lindsay ruth hale ergo parker parker

[02:45:58] so move exactly uh miss holton i dr siebert mr hansen hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. And chair votes aye.

[02:46:20] Okay. Now, ladies and gentlemen, we are moving to item F, right? Is that right? No, E, excuse me. Right? Let me get to mine. F is perfect. Hang on, hang on.

[02:46:40] We're going to do F first, please. Item F first, please. very much so everyone is on the same page we're item f please

[02:47:12] jordan armstrong thank you for being flexible and pivoting for us today those are our key words today certainly and good morning madam chair and board members i am pleased to provide you all with this overview of the germana community college future educators academy lab school proposal this is a partnership among germana community college laurel ridge community college james madison university and the superintendent's regent for school divisions of culpepper

[02:47:48] madison clark fauquier frederick page rappahannock shenandoah warren and winchester city for your consideration for approval today i would like to first thank the members of the college partnership lab schools standing committee including chair mrs joan wadiska virginia board of education members mr bill hansen mr andy rotherham and members mr john bailey and dr pam ran for their time their feedback and their commitment to lab schools and the additional opportunities afforded by lab schools on behalf of the students of the commonwealth joining me today from fea are mrs taylor landry special assistant to the president for strategic initiatives of germana community

[02:48:26] College, Ms. Brenda Byard, the FEA Grand Administrator, as well as Dr. Janet Gullickson, President of Germanna Community College, Dr. Shoshana Gray, the VP of Academic Affairs and Workforce Development at Germanna, Dr. Kiana Hawkins, the Director of Equity Advancement for Germanna, and Dr. Eric Earnhardt, Dean of Arts and Sciences for Germanna, and Dr. Tony Bratz, Superintendent of Culpeper County Public Schools. Upon completion of my report, I will invite Ms.

[02:48:51] Landry and Ms. Byard and the FEA team to provide a brief overview of their proposal and to introduce other special guests representing the fea today the goal of fea to provide high quality accelerated teacher education to produce exceptional teachers is responsive to the continuing shortage of qualified professional teachers in central virginia students enrolled in the fea lab school will experience hand-on exposure to the teaching profession and participate in a streamlined scalable model designed to accelerate the path to full teacher licensure including dual enrollment coursework toward an associate's degree that will include several required courses and

[02:49:27] experiences needed to achieve full licensure as a Virginia teacher, allowing students to potentially graduate and apply to local school division teacher openings two years post-graduation. The VDOE received the FEA application on August 10, 2023, and in the intervening three months, the agency has collaborated with FEA as follows. During the week of August 21st, the VDOE's subject matter expert team provided detailed feedback in each compliance-related section of the application. The goal of this

team is to document the needed technical expertise and provide counseling to the applicants in order to identify and correct any potential deficiencies

[02:50:04] in the planning and implementation of the proposed lab school, determine compliance with state law regulation, highlight potential problems or red flags with information contained in the application, and to identify aspects of the proposal that are especially exciting or unique. That subject matter team includes myself, Mr. Rob Gilstrap, Ms. Amy Siebka, Ms. Rebecca Askew, Dr. John Hendren, Mr. Ed Lanza, Ms. Melissa Velasquez, Dr. Samantha Hollins, and Dr. Dave Myers. Each of those subject matter experts was provided with the Laboratory School Criteria Checklist Worksheet, and areas of expertise were assigned to these staff based on their expertise here at the VDOE.

[02:50:43] That is included in the Completeness and Compliance Report, which corresponds to the lab school application and that reflects the following dimensions of compliance: an executive summary, mission and vision, educational program, governance, management structure, financial and operations, placement plan, and other assurances. The applicant, Germana Community College, FEA, was responsive to our feedback and questions and they provided edits to their application and addendums as required to meet compliance. Items that required attention by the applicant included a revised budget to meet the per pupil funding limit, clarification of compliance with human resources and student records requirements, additional detail related

[02:51:23] to testing and accountability, and expansion of language related to sustainability. The applicant responded with their edited application and addenda on September 12, 2023, which was subsequently reviewed by the subject matter experts on September 15, 2023. Once it was established that the applicant had provided satisfactory responses to the VDOE, the FEA application was placed on the for first standing committee review on October 3rd, 2023. The FEA presented to the standing committee on October 3rd, responded to questions of the committee, and was unanimously approved by the standing committee on October 3rd to proceed to second standing committee review on November

[02:52:02] 6th, 2023. The FEA application was posted for public comment following the October 3rd meeting, and there was no comment received between October 12th and October 27th. The FEA proposal was subsequently unanimously approved by the standing committee upon second review to be forwarded for consideration today by the Virginia Board of Education. On behalf of the VDOE, I submit that the Germana Community College Future Educators Academy Lab School is compliant and ready to implement, and I recommend to the board that the Future Educators Academy be approved and subsequently begin the contract approval process. Now to share briefly more about FEA, I am again

[02:52:41] joined by Ms. Taylor Landry and Ms. Brenda Byard who will provide additional information, introduce their guests and attendants on behalf of FEA and answer any questions you all may have from the board. Ms. Landry, Ms. Byard. Good morning thank you so much for having us here today. So as you may know and has been stated here there is a severe teacher shortage and in the middle of September it was reported that there were over 43 teacher vacancies in the state. As such four superintendents

[02:53:18] orange madison culpepper and rappahannock got together and they're trying to figure out a way to solve their own problems not having enough teachers in their rural counties and so that's why we are here today with this proposal the mission of future educators academy is to produce well well prepared future educators by providing accessible supportive and innovative learning experiences and we

will talk with you about that in a few minutes the vision provide that high quality teacher education license your pathway to these young people a diverse group of juniors and

[02:53:55] seniors in high school through the collaborative partnerships of laurel ridge dramatic community college george james madison university and also mary washington university of mary washington i just wanted to mention 4 300 over 4 300 um vacancies that we have teacher shortage that's addressing the teacher shortage so the instructional model takes rising 11th grade graders into the program so 11th and 12th graders will essentially complete an associate degree in

[02:54:31] education while concurrently completing their profile of virginia graduation requirements all of the courses will be dual enrolled and we work very hard to make sure that they align with um college classes align with high school graduation requirements the degrees degree will transfer seamlessly to the school of education at james madison university and the university of mary washington we are working very hard to finalize articulation agreements so students who normally transfer from the community college they transfer to a university they don't transfer directly into

[02:55:09] into a school of. We are working very hard to make sure our students can transfer to the School of Education, and both universities are receptive to that. The education degree prepares students to pursue elementary and special ed, the two top critical need areas in the Commonwealth.

[02:55:29] Students who want to pursue math and English, we have a pathway to help them do that. They have to just take additional classes in the summer, work with dual enrollment specialists and others in the community college to show them how they can go back to their base high school when they leave FEA, get those classes, take some classes in the summer so that they can come up to speed.

[02:55:49] But we know through transfer Virginia what students need in order to transfer into particular degrees. Students will complete the degree as a cohort of 24 students on the campus of Culpeper at the Daniel Technology Center initially in the fall of 2024.

[02:56:07] And then expansion will happen in the Laurel Ridge service region in fall 25 at both campuses, Middletown and the Falker campus. Thank you, Brenda. So I know that one question is, how do we sustain this? How do we cover the costs associated with providing this program, this academy for students? And we see this as multi streams of funding in order to make sure that we're covering our expenses.

[02:56:36] The startup funds associated with the college partnership lab schools are helping us seed this academy, especially until we're ready to launch multiple cohorts. We've got our juniors and seniors enrolled concurrently. We need to use those startup funds to help cover the cost of faculty maintaining the building and preparing the spaces for students so that they're in the most high quality learning environment possible.

[02:57:00] And we want to use that per pupil funding to cover the things that are critical to student success. We know that students are going to encounter barriers on this journey. We know that this may be a challenge for them. We want to make sure they've got access to internet, that they're not having to cover the cost of textbooks, that we're covering that for them, that they've got snacks and breakfast items because we know that hungry students aren't able to be as successful in their classroom.

[02:57:23] We really are looking at these per pupil funds to build wraparound services, cover the cost of exceptional faculty, exceptional support staff, and the services and tools that are necessary for students so that what they can focus on is just doing their very best of class. We know that community support is

critical, and we're very fortunate that we've seen a lot of support for this concept for the Future Educators Academy already. Beyond saying that we're going to work with foundations and we're going to work with community members and donors, we really want to highlight ways that we can articulate the value of those donations and how

[02:57:58] those are applied. Concepts like sponsor a future teacher where someone can donate funds to future educators academy and cover the cost of a student's tuition and textbooks and other materials is a great way of building that sense of connection between our donors who are who are interested in donating because they know how critical teachers are to our entire community and of course connecting them to our students and then finally school division funding that is inspired by a governor's school model with a per slot charge is something that we've discussed with the

[02:58:32] partnering school divisions as a way of covering gaps and ensuring sustainability we already have a formula in place with our governor schools to cover some of those student learning expenses and we know that we can adjust and apply that to fea as well thank you taylor so these young people 16 and 17 18 years old as they graduate high school and they graduate maybe 17 with an associate degree in education we know that they're going to need some help so we have

[02:59:07] when we designed the courses we talked about what courses we knew that students might struggle with statistics for example we plan to embed tutors automatically in those classes to assist students so that they can be successful students disability services we had great conversations with our colleagues at the secondary level if a student has a 504 they have an iup those same disability services accommodations would be available to them through the future educators academy on fridays we plan to have our friday tutor sessions for students who may struggle in addition

[02:59:44] to those experiential learning experiences that we may have but there will be opportunities for tutoring on fridays when students go back to their base high school they have leadership seminars at their base high school so they have an opportunity to meet with a teacher a resource teacher participate in a club or do whatever but they have an opportunity to get additional help if a student is struggling the students who attend the fea academy will have a record of achievement when they leave us we want them to have completed that math praxis exam or the exam that is required by james madison university and also completed and passed the virginia communication literacy

[03:00:22] assessment so that they are actually ready to go into the school of education mentorship through JMU and UMW faculty and other professionals in the field we want them to know what it is to be a professional educator to know what the soft skills are that are required the dispositions that are required confidentiality so that they walk into that classroom and they are very well prepared to be there experiential learning experiences there are two courses that require practicums of 20 hours they will be completing those in their school divisions as well as

[03:00:57] Participating perhaps in a faculty meeting, an IEP meeting, if that would be possible, a parent conference, so that they can learn what it is to be a professional educator and they know some of the issues that you have to deal with.

[03:01:12] And then campuses to or visits to the campuses of JMU and UMW so that they can learn who the faculty are. We have worked very closely with JMU education faculty. We know who they are. They're very welcoming to us and they will be to our students. and we want our students to visit the school of education at jmu and the same for umw thanks brenda ultimately when we're talking about future

educators academy we're talking about a program that is helping us get cohorts of passionate teachers to the finish line with their degree with their teacher licensure and get into classrooms where they can teach and do what they

[03:01:51] love faster and smoother we're trying to eliminate barriers for students who know that they want to be teachers and make that process as smooth as possible we're accelerating and we're we're iterating so that we're using research-backed pedagogical best practices we're trying new things we're creating an opportunity for students to observe teaching best practices in multiple school divisions so that experiential learning piece that Brenda was talking about they are doing those practicum hours at four different school divisions and those divisions have committed

[03:02:26] to ensuring that those students are seeing what the schools do best so that the entire time that they're in this program they are surrounded by hands-on learning and classroom learning that shows best practices innovation and new ideas that they can they can bring they can bring that energy to their classroom we know that we've got community support we've got that now and we're going to see that continue to be integrated into the future educators academy through things like advisory boards soft skills workshops and trainings and sponsorship opportunities and we believe that this

[03:03:01] accelerating learn accelerated learning opportunity is replicable and scalable we see how this is going to work first at one location at germana after one year we're going to be expanding to locations at laurel ridge and we really think that this is something that could be expanded to other institutions across the commonwealth because we know we don't have enough teachers and we need to address this and we know that students want to be teachers they just need the additional support in order to get there i wanted go ahead go ahead um i just wanted to take a second to thank you and to

[03:03:38] thank our incredible germana team dr armstrong introduced everybody when he was doing his presentation but i know that folks may um want to share their thoughts and feelings or respond to your questions. And we look forward to answering any questions that you may have.

[03:04:00] Madam Chair, board members, any questions for the FEA team? Anybody have any questions? Dr. Northern? Yeah, so I love the model. I'm just wondering how you're fitting it all in, right? It's a simple question. I see that the students are going to still receive an advanced studies diploma, which is 26 units of credit, five verified. And then they're going to be, you know, earning an AA degree, which it's obviously, a lot of these are dual degree. But I mean, across the country, we're trying to figure out like, how do we make time for kids to do apprenticeships and these other workforce learning when they've, you know, got a lot to do to graduate. So how are you guys

[03:04:38] fitting all this? And you mentioned accelerated learning, but I'm not so sure I caught what the, you know, repercussions of that were. But can you talk about a little bit about how everything gets fit in along with everything that they need to graduate high school? We're going to bring up Dr. Kiana Hawkins. She handles the early college program at Tramana and let her address that.

[03:05:02] Hi, good morning. So I have the honor of leading two of our early college programs. And you were right. We have a very strict schedule that we follow. And so the students actually, we coordinate with the local high schools where we have them bused in. And then they go to their first class and they have a little break. We feed them and they go to their second class and they're back at their high school by lunch.

[03:05:24] And so in addition to that, we work with our students who play sports. So we work with them about time management and how to fit all these things in. And we would do the same with our practicums. We would work with our partners to schedule that in to their schedule. So are they just taking fewer electives or?

[03:05:41] Yeah, so their core classes, they're getting dual enrollment for all of their core classes. And then we work with all the counselors for each student to see, okay, what classes do you still need at your high school to graduate? And if they don't need the electives, they don't take them. They like to focus on Germana or if they're really interested in doing yearbook, they'll do yearbook and then they'll still come back to Germana.

[03:06:02] So sometimes they take fewer electives, sometimes they don't. So they get dual enrollment for all of their classes, no matter what that course is. So it'll be, they get dual enrollment for English, for math, for history and for science. Okay. Okay. Thank you. Okay.

[03:06:19] Ms. Holtan. Okay. Thank you for this opportunity. We've been in the dual enrollment early college business for quite some time. Our current graduation rate for our dual enrolled students is 92%. Ms. Walton?

[03:06:36] Well, I just want to say thank you and congratulations you all have put together. Obviously, a wonderful plan, including I appreciate hearing the financial sustainability. And obviously, a significant piece of that is the support from the divisions, which I'm sure they're enthusiastically able to do because they want these teachers in their classrooms.

[03:06:58] uh i was on a panel uh was part of a conference last week sponsored by the u.s department of of education on uh raising the bar by via more successful transfer pathways and the transfer va folks were there and i'm sure they've been good partners to you and one of the uh remaining challenges more generally that you all are obviously figuring out but maybe we can all learned from you is to not well first of all to make sure that all the credits transfer not just to the university but towards the major and i hear you're working on that but also the second part

[03:07:34] that the dual enrollment courses transfer towards the university and towards the major and that's an extra um bridge to cross and so you all figure that out and then share that with the rest of us dr siebert yeah just a really common kudos i love the fact that it's regional multiple divisions you're looking at multiple uh higher educations that it's um scalable that it's it's already you know um sustainable in terms of cost but i really am excited about the how it's replicable in terms of other regions throughout the commonwealth so i just think it's kind of a big wow you know back

[03:08:12] to the question i think dr norther was bringing up about um room and children's schedules you know the board is going to be looking at in the years to come you know redesigning high school and so there's going to be opportunities for feedback from groups like yours on how we can look at you know this this over 100 year old reliance on the carnegie unit and and what we can do to further innovate and do some things there so don't be shy about bringing lessons learned back through the processes the department will be and then lastly we just want to personally thank you all for your patience with the work of the board today and the time it took to get to your excellent presentation um so thank thank you very very much for being here to the group the team dr brads

[03:08:50] anything else i would just like to say to you all you um had me grinning from ear to ear with clinical placement hours that's for certain um that is one thing that that our students need desperately in our epps because they need to see the reality of classroom work every day day in and day out they need to know it's not all sunshine and roses all the time and they also need to learn skills around how to communicate better communication between

[03:09:27] their colleagues communication with parents and what those things look like as it being such a huge part of our profession so i'm really excited about that piece and and thank you all okay so um with that is there a motion to waive first review and approve the germana lab school application for a three-year period with annual reviews and to delegate to the president and the superintendent and superintendent final negotiation of the lab school contract including awarding

[03:10:03] startup funds and up to six million in per people funding from the college partnership laboratory school fund in accordance with the board's guidelines so moved second miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hanson miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr sturdifan hi mr rotherham and chair votes

[03:10:28] i congratulations and thank you so much thank you so much thank you yeah now card and dr armstrong it's you again yes ma'am madam chair and board members i am also pleased to provide you with this overview of the university of mary washington academy of technology and innovation known as the ati lab school and its proposal ati is a collaboration among university of mary

[03:11:05] washington and stafford county public schools as the fiscal and hiring agent as well as the four other school divisions in superintendents region three including caroline frederick's caroline county fredericksburg city king george county and spottsylvania county for your consideration for approval today i would again like to thank the members of the college partnership lab school standing committee for their time feedback and commitment to lab schools and additional opportunities afforded by lab schools on behalf of the students of the commonwealth joining me today are dr rebecca towery executive director of ati and other guests supporting ati which included dr thomas taylor superintendent stafford county but he had to head over to vsba

[03:11:42] so we had to take take a leave a few minutes ago we also have some other members of the team from mayor washington who dr tower will introduce momentarily and i will get for a chance to do that after my report and they will provide a brief overview of their proposal the goal of ati combining an emphasis on computer and data science fields with innovative interdisciplinary teaching practices and learning experiences for high school students is responsive to the continuing demand for skilled graduates prepared to enter the computer and data science industry Additionally, a local market demand in the region served by ATI.

[03:12:16] The student experience at ATI will be characterized by project-based authentic learning approaches where field experiences will be leveraged whenever possible to ensure students engage in authentic learning and real-world problem solving. This approach will ensure students are able to witness and experience the application of computer science, data science, and broader technology across content areas and economic industries through work-based learning experiences as part of this approach intentionality will be given towards the provision of externships and internships to build the durable skills necessary to enter the workforce umw will leverage all three of its colleges to support the efforts of the lab school providing content

[03:12:55] experts from the college of arts and sciences the college of businesses to consult and development of curricular resources and field experiences in partnership with the college of education and stafford schools the video received the ati application on august the 7th 2023 and in the intervening three months the agency has collaborated with the applicant as follows during the week of august 21st the video subject matter expert team provided detailed feedback in each compliance related section of the application in order to ensure compliance and provide counseling to ati in order to identify and correct any potential potential deficiencies in planning

[03:13:32] and implementation as described previously the subject matter team included the same video each staff that i named in my previous overview of the fea who underwent the same process providing feedback and comments related to individual areas of expertise in each application section which includes the executive summary mission and vision educational program governance management structure financial operations placement plan and other assurances the applicant ati was responsive to the subject matter expert feedback and questions and provided edits their application and addendums as required to meet compliance items that required attention by the applicant

[03:14:09] included clarification on the targeted student population attachment of a link detail in the instructional and curriculum model schedule governance structure and parental involvement plan of ati a code of conduct and details on financials and clarification related to proposed facility an on-site visit was additionally scheduled to provide technical assistance in preparation for final application submission responsive to the subject matter expert feedback and to better assess the true facility needs of ATI.

[03:14:36] This visit took place at the UMW Stafford campus on Tuesday, September 19th, with Ms. Wadiska, myself, and Dr. Towery. And I will tell you, the facility that we saw is outstanding. So I definitely checked all the boxes there for us when we visited on site. ATI presented to the Standing Committee on October 3rd, responded to questions of the committee, and was approved by the Standing Committee on October 3rd to proceed to second Standing Committee review.

[03:15:01] The ATI application was posted for public comment following the October 3rd Standing Committee meeting on October 12th and remained available until October 27th, and no comment was received. The ATI proposal was subsequently unanimously approved by the Standing Committee upon second review to be forwarded for your consideration today by the Virginia Board of Education.

[03:15:21] On behalf of the BDOE, I submit that the University of Mary Washington Academy of Technology and Innovation Lab School is compliant and ready to implement. I recommend to the board that the Academy of Technology and Innovation be approved and subsequently begin the contract approval process.

[03:15:36] And here to share more about ATI and introduce her guest, I am again joined by Dr. Rebecca Towery, Executive Director, who will give us a brief overview. Dr. Towery. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong.

[03:15:53] Thank you for having us here today. I am joined by Dr. Timothy O'Donnell, provost and chief academic officer at the University of Mary Washington, as well as Dr. Pete Kelly, dean of the College of Education. So we are incredibly excited about the work that we have been doing regionally to build out a regional high school program that will be able to explore these innovative approaches around building STEM skills into content area approaches, supporting teacher preparation, and seeking to provide service to the community.

[03:16:29] So our mission is really around this building out a demonstration site that provides innovative, authentic learning experiences that will prepare students to leverage computer and data science across academic and economic sectors. So we are really trying to build out a place where both kids who see themselves as computer and data scientists and kids who don't necessarily see themselves as computer and data scientists, but see themselves primarily as kids who love history or love art, learn key technology skills that they are going

[03:17:04] to need in today's marketplace to make themselves marketable in whatever field they want to go into. So whether that's running data analytics for healthcare industries or building out and designing websites, you are supporting them in, as you kind of see in that infographic to the right, that learning that reciprocal relationship that it increasingly exists between computer and data science and that continuous improvement process and then seeing how that can apply across different fields so that kind of kicks right into our vision in terms of creating that collaborative

[03:17:38] innovative and highly qualified learners educators and community contributors we have a um so in terms of our instructional model for this regional high school program we are um kind of i've got three kind of categories they're highlighted right so we're leveraging that robust partnership with umw to provide content area experts support with the teacher pipeline umw and germana that was just here they recently were awarded a noise scholarship grant and so we think there's perfect kind of synergy here to um i don't expect

[03:18:18] We anticipate about 100 students per cohort, and I don't expect all 100 of those to go into teaching, but I would love to see through that close partnership with the College of Education for several of each of those cohort members to catch that teaching bug, as we say, and get excited about working with students.

[03:18:37] We're hoping to do some summer programs during the summers that will be geared towards kind of that K through eight age range. And so there will be some unique opportunities to expose high school students to what you can do in the teaching. And then through a very interdisciplinary approach, which I heard in the last dialogue around looking at Carnegie units.

[03:19:03] right and so um there are some really neat things you can do through interdisciplinary approaches through doing integrated courses through seeing how you can not only take explicit courses in data and computer science but make sure that you are practicing those skills when you take your history when you take your environmental science classes and so that you are seeing that life application and then really that project-based learning we've already been talking heavily with dahlgren in the area and other cyber security companies and different

[03:19:38] local businesses around how we can support as well as community organizations where students might be able to essentially do some service learning with helping provide data analytics to local nonprofits build out websites etc and then finally through personalized learning in addition to kind of classroom learning we're looking at building in independent study opportunities and having a dedicated staff member that will help kind of customize pathways for students where they are augmenting what they're doing in their whole class environments with small group learning

[03:20:13] and individual courses of study to augment and come out of this we're really looking at pathways for both students who want to go directly into the workforce as well as those who want to get some higher ed access prior to graduation and then we are working with our local community college

partners and of course umw to look at a full kind of dual enrollment early college pathways as well it will be a small school environment um we anticipate having about 400 students total in kind of this first campus and then seeking to move some things out so from a sustainability

[03:20:52] uh standpoint uh much like germana we are looking at a braided approach to sustainability so we will of course be seeking to apply for state additional grant funding we will also be looking at competitive grants we do have uh commitments from four of the initial five school divisions for um full operational agreements and commitments around kind of an annual local contribution and And that does, while we are able to keep that still competitively under average per pupil expenditure, even at the end of the state funding, that will allow us to build sustainability.

[03:21:31] And then we are also working, UMW Foundation is building out some dedicated funding lines where we will be able to solicit private donations as well. So support and partnerships, I've already kind of alluded to this as I've been speaking some, but we've had really wonderful feedback and dialogue. I meet with area superintendents about once a month, and they have been instrumental in providing feedback and refinement to this process so we can make sure that it's meeting needs.

[03:22:06] I've also been working regularly with our regional Chamber of Commerce, Fredericksburg Regional Alliance, and local economic development authorities, as well as local businesses to make sure that we are designing things in a way where kids are going to get those real world up and take learning experiences that help them develop those durable and soft skills, those five C's that are going to make them highly marketable as they go in and highly prepared as they go into the workforce.

[03:22:34] business partnerships. We will continue to build this out as we go in, but I have a number of employers that are very excited about us potentially providing them with software developers and others who can support their work. And then, of course, higher education. UMW is obviously fully invested in this. This is just kind of that win-win of where by providing those high-quality

[03:23:01] the high school program experiences, you are also providing those future educators in the College of Education with kind of those best practices for teaching and learning that they will take hopefully back out into those very same school division that are participating.

[03:23:18] And so you're building that local pool in terms of outcomes. Again, I've kind of highlighted some of this already, but but high academic achievement, real world preparation. really do think, you know, I have, we've got built into our budget, um, essentially a systems and outreach coordinator who will hopefully be working with students to develop these customized pathways where they are helping them navigate between the worlds of K-12, higher ed, and the business community to, it's, it's kind of the concept of work-based learning, but, um, on a more of a

[03:23:53] systems level. And so that teacher preparation and pipeline is also, also huge. We are meeting annually or monthly i should say department of college of education and myself and others to really look at how we can build this out as a true demonstration site and teaching hospital that is working regularly with both teacher preparation as well as existing teachers to look at innovative approaches in the classroom and then of course our goal is to pilot and develop educational resources that can be disseminated um across the region and ultimately the state

[03:24:31] through the work we're doing so thank you for the time are there any questions i can take board members have questions dr northern and maybe i lost it but is there a particular curriculum that

you're using so we so we will of course be doing standards right the virginia standards of learning we do have and i don't have it on a slide but we do have kind of a full course map out of

[03:25:06] core content that students will be taking we are looking at an integrated english and history approach and then we have a kind of some mandatory electives you might say in computer and data science that students will take i anticipate that students will um they may say generalists with computer and data science but i imagine i'm kind of in their freshman year they're going to take a semester-long exploratory of both of those and then what i think will happen is they will start to hone in on okay i love political science and i really kind of like this data science so as i

[03:25:43] build out my pathway i'm going to take our coding language and some of these different things because i know that those are key skills for me to have as i go into the workforce does that help a little bit you're not you guys are still figuring that out sounds like so i have a full four-year course map out and then what we will be doing kind of the work this semester is the detailed curriculum scope of sequence that's increasing miss ashton yeah um just want to applaud the work and super excited about the focus on computer science and data science um have you thought about like

[03:26:22] certifications that um students could potentially earn as well yes one of the conversations i've been having with both germana and rappahannock community college because they both kind of feed into or some are some of the different um certifications that might align well here and what we might um i'm going to forget the higher ed term for this is it the um fast forward program okay so we are looking at how we can potentially do some creative partnerships there where um there might be essentially some concurrent enrollment where

[03:27:00] we provide wraparound supports to k-12 the k-12 students in the program that are taking those and maybe bringing in some subject matter experts for some of that and um we are of course looking at you know your CompTIA certifications and then I've also been looking at um you know uh I was in a meeting yesterday with some other k-12 people in AWS so potentially some AWS certifications with some of the economic development in the area right now and some of some of those sorts of certifications further questions thank you so much thank you we're happy to have you okay

[03:27:40] that being said is there a motion to waive first review and approve sorry I got to get on the next page where am i what number am i on that better be on g right yeah that's what i did okay um and approve the university of mary washington application for a three-year period with annual reviews and to delegate the president and superintendent final negotiation of the lab school contract including awarding startup funds and up to six million dollars in per pupil funding from the college partnership laboratory school fund in accordance with the

[03:28:19] board's guidelines second any discussion miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hanson hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr sturdifan mr rotherham hi and chair votes i thank you so much yes no discussion on the amendment i did want to just take a moment to thank dr armstrong for his work bringing these two through there's a couple more in the pipeline there's a meeting coming up in december with a pretty full agenda and he's just really done a fantastic job and i wanted to call that out and

[03:28:59] also just call out not particular either of these the diversity of what we're seeing so we had one focus on educator prep we've got you know obviously one already going with code rva we've got another one now with with more of a tech focus that like we're seeing around the state this and this is choice means choice and and these are not sort of you know five different flavors of vanilla it's really genuinely

different kinds of things and that's just uh just tremendous thank you so much um so if i don't have a revolve on my hands we're going to do a couple of quick items here

[03:29:33] um if we can move to the approval of the consent agenda item um which is a first and final review to certify list of qualified persons for the office of division superintendent of schools is there a motion to approve the consent agenda i move okay miss holton hi dr siebert hi mr hanson

[03:30:02] hi miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr sturdifant hi mr rotherham and chair votes i um and then item e thank you president creasy members of the board dr coons um this item is what i think we would consider a routine item this is a appointments one of the board's advisory committees in this instance the early childhood advisory committee has put out a call for nominations staff has vetted

[03:30:37] nominees and is presenting the following two recommended recommendations for a representative of a head start provider not operated by local school division and for a nomination of a representative of statewide nonprofit association the commonwealth whose membership includes both before and at school and after school non-profit child care providers and non-profit preschool providers um those are presented in your agenda packet and we're available if any there are any questions is there a motion to waive first review and approve the nominations as presented in this

[03:31:12] item so move second miss holton aye dr siebert aye mr hanson hi miss ashton aye dr northern hi mr sturdifant all right mr rotherham and chair votes i okay um i'm awaiting dr coons if we could hold for one moment please oh not many more moments i promise

[03:31:52] okay see i just do this very well i string you along all right we are going to knock out item i as well which is um the uh presentation by dr solari um of the core instructional program guide k5 madam president i know it's not going to take long thank you thank you for having me again um we're going to hopefully go through this relatively quickly because i spent some time with you all last last month about process um so what we have before you today is just the

[03:32:31] It's K-5 core curriculum, so we do not have a list yet for supplemental intervention. As I explained last time I was here, that will come in the new year. So as a part of the VLA, everyone is aware that there is to be an approved list for core supplemental intervention materials.

[03:32:53] At this point today, we have a vetted list of K-5 core curriculum to present to the board. My colleague Ann Eaton is here, and she has been overseeing this massive project.

[03:33:09] There have been hundreds of Virginia educators involved in this process, and we think it's an exciting day to be here finally, where we have a list to present to you all to vet and for approval. So we have worked with over 200 educators across the Commonwealth, many facilitators, folks who work both in the Virginia Literacy Partnerships Office, the University of Virginia, area and folks in different divisions across the community to oversee this process.

[03:33:38] The intent here is to ensure that every child when they are in the K-5 classroom have access to evidence-based literacy instruction that's been vetted by a comprehensive process. So part of this is that we will have a core instructional program guide.

[03:33:53] The guide will include a list of K-5 core instructional programs and also a snapshot of each program that we have reviewed. So to inform folks who are in the position of purchasing curriculum about that particular program.

[03:34:09] The point here is that every program has strengths and weaknesses. That's just the reality of curricula, right? And so we wanna make sure that folks are in the position of vetting these within the context of their own community. They have choice and they also are aware of the strengths and weaknesses of each program.

[03:34:27] so that's the intent of the snapshot for each core program so this is the list um column approved in June 2023 is the is the list that this body approved for just K to three core is what we brought the first time because during back in June 2023 we had did not have a four to eight Virginia Literacy Act yet um we started reviewing programs for four and five um when you know in

[03:34:54] Participation of the Virginia Literacy Act being expanded 4 to 8, and so now we have a list for approval that spans K to 5, and these are the different ones that have made it through the comprehensive review process and are being presented to the board for approval.

[03:35:12] Each one of these has that snapshot with further information about the program, and that this is what it looks like. This is also available to the board and essentially says, what are the program strengths? What are the program's challenges? And across every grade level for the different areas that we review that were part of the rubric, whether that they met expectation, partly met expectation, did not meet expectation, or if it wasn't reviewed for that particular grade level because it wasn't developmentally appropriate.

[03:35:40] And this again is to serve divisions in their decision-making process. So our next steps, the Board will review the Core Instructional Program Guide for approval at its next meeting. They will be available publicly, and there is a survey that folks can provide feedback.

[03:36:01] We are also at the same time moving forward with the Cycle 2 review of the K-8 Supplemental Intervention Programs that will conclude in early 2024, which time we will bring that list to this to the board again um and hopefully that process will be concluded early in 2024 because we know that there are many divisions that are eager to buy materials both core supplemental and intervention and then also the video we will launch a vla implementation playbook that includes a framework for implementation for folks to implement new curriculum we know that

[03:36:35] purchasing curriculum is just the first very first step and we have to support every division every division of their implementation okay so that was my speedy speedy sorry moving forward for you guys um we're happy to answer any questions that you might have um and specific questions about specific curricula um ann is here as well because she really does know every single thing about these different programs at this point well we are so thankful for you being here and we wanted to squeeze you in and not make you sit here during our lunch um we're so sorry to hear about the situation that you are in with your husband and can just want you to know that we're

[03:37:14] thinking of you and your family and praying for you thank you i appreciate that miss holton hi thank you for your hard work both of you and your presentation i am looking at a letter from dr uh ferlita white the superintendent of roanoke city who is superstar superintendent i'm sure you know including is our virginia superintendent of the year and she submitted a letter as part of our public comment raising questions about the wit and wisdom curriculum uh created by i think

[03:37:46] i have knowledge matters campaign and okay thank you um um and yes i see that the parent company of wit and wisdom so um i'm hoping you all can address that uh um when we're up when this

matters up for final review next month. And we would sure love it if you all could meet with, I would love it if you all could meet with Roanoke in the meanwhile, and perhaps with written wisdom and go through the elements. But she tells us, and again, this is just relying on her letter, but

[03:38:21] that this curriculum has been approved in other states that have implemented the science of reading, including mississippi that we're relying on tennessee and others uh and that they submitted 146 day 146 page appeal and still got rejected and didn't get any explanation i'm not assuming that those facts are um exactly as you would view them but um but i do think they call forth for a detailed response and hoping you can meet with them and then be ready to help clarify to us next month is that a possibility absolutely we've already met with wit and wisdom and and can speak

[03:39:01] to that a little bit more than i can and provided them feedback and very happy we are anytime happy to meet with any superintendent we have already met with several through this process i'm very happy to meet with them to speak about it mr rotherham yeah i'm not going to get involved in any particular providers i'm recusing myself from those words i have a general process question could you talk about a little bit just briefly what are we doing as we're getting these ratings what is the process i know you went through this a little bit but as well on so making sure we have just good intra-rater reliabilities or excuse me inter and intra-rater reliability so we can just make

[03:39:39] sure there's consistency and particularly where there's wide variance and what the scores are coming up with what's the what's the process there to assure consistency yeah i can speak of that and then and can add on to that so i'll train all um reviewers are trained um to fidelity on the rubric and then we have a group of facilitators who oversee each review group and those that group of facilitators meets together to ensure consistency both across in and within review group do you want to speak a little bit to that and sure so one of the things

[03:40:13] that we do amongst our facilitator team is we have that interrater reliability where we meet to discuss especially when programs are similar or when we need to meet so we do norm the same across all programs but when programs are more similar to each other than others then we make sure that those are being normed in the same way so we do that two ways one we have like a larger group meeting where we talk across and then in situations where um we know that the programs are a little bit more complex or require an even deeper dive than we're already doing then we do a smaller almost like a focus group of facilitators and that includes folks who have been

[03:40:53] a part of this process from its origin so building the rubrics looking across states bringing it through every part of that so so those folks are part of that sort of core facilitator group and that provides some oversight to that to that process as a whole dr siever a couple quick questions uh so you know when is going to be the next opportunity to for other organizations to fulfill the requirements for feedback to be brought to us how soon is that going to happen and then in terms of the facilitators and reviewers again this is a huge lift large numbers of people

[03:41:30] involved tremendous virginia participation but of facilitators and reviewers ballpark number percentage non-binding how many are within virginia how many are with outside of virginia so the reviewers are 100 in virginia one of the um one of the strongest aspects of our curriculum can you speak in the microphone for bill yes where's the microphone right here yes is it on are we good okay um one of the strongest components of this review is that for

[03:42:04] our review teams uh so the reviewers come from all over the state of virginia they are representative of all of the regions of Virginia, but then even I think what I am particularly part of is that on every single team we have one person who is an admin or division level, we have one person who's a literacy coach or reading specialist, and then we have one person who's a classroom teacher, and that's on every single review team. Facilitators, I'm going to say 90 percent live in the state of Virginia. The only folks who do not live in the state of Virginia are folks that were hired by

[03:42:40] Virginia Literacy Partnerships, and so they are already deep in the work of Virginia. It's just those few facilitators who come from outside the state, but I'm not even sure if 10% if it's fair to say that. Do you have a better idea? That's about 10% because we have employees who work out remotely out of the site. Further questions? The next opportunity. I'm sorry. The next opportunity. For core or supplemental or intervention, I just wanted some clarification on the question oh just what this this more uh there's there's a desire for feedback opportunity to respond to that feedback so what's going to be the next opportunity to update this list

[03:43:19] so we are going to open up another um subliminal and core review in the subliminal intervention review in the in the new year because there were several programs that didn't have the opportunity to submit in the second cycle and i believe the decision on core is yet to be made about when we open up a new cycle but um dr kins may have some feedback we are just working with funding to be able to do that so we will we are working on it to make sure it will happen yeah further questions dr northern um i've been checking but can you just uh tell me whether any of the curriculum

[03:43:57] has a does not meet expectations from the ed reports reviews i see some have parsley meets but are you aware as compared to the ed reports if any of have a does not meet expectation i I'm going to have to go back and check. That's a good question. I'm going to go back and check. We haven't done that side-by-side comparison. There are programs reviewed that do meet for our reports that do not meet our criteria, so it goes that way.

[03:44:23] But we can absolutely check and report back on our next meeting for the first question. Thank you. Anything else? Thank you very much. Thank you both so much. We appreciate you, and we'll see you in December. great thank you thank you um so at this point we will take a lunch break until 1 15. is that good

[03:44:47] all right thank you we're going up skipped around because of different people being here and

[04:34:49] prepared and ready to roll with their presentations at different times so we thank you for hanging on and at this point the board will hear item b discussion of the comprehensive plan Thank you, President Creasy, Vice President Hanson, members of the board, Superintendent Koons.

[04:35:10] We're very grateful for the feedback that the board provided at the October meeting where, you know, the department received really significant, I think, direction on how you would like this comprehensive plan to start taking shape. Under the leadership of Dr. Koons and Dr. Raley, we have worked very hard to turn around this early draft that we provided to you in advance of this meeting.

[04:35:33] has been through some revisions as Ms. Holden has noted. I would love to emphasize that this is still an early draft but we wanted to make sure we offered you a complete a document as possible. You'll notice that all of almost all the appendices are are complete and attached and we have you know full pros but again still still an early draft that we expect to to be revised. If we can start off real quickly you know in

terms of the large structure and at a very high level the purpose of the comprehensive plan has been revised slightly in the draft before you um the board's mission has

[04:36:11] stayed the same from the previous vision since that is taken directly from the board's bylaws the objectives of education in virginia have undergone some revisions and we'll cover that in in just a moment um and then the as the board's request i believe this was was mr hanson and it sounded like there was general consent among the board um that the uh the analysis uh the extent to which the objectives of education are being achieved um could could mirror the annual report and so um miss holton between drafts a lot of those revisions came in in that section to make sure that we were aligning um the analysis of the objectives of education uh and the extent

[04:36:50] to which they're being met to what's in the the most recent edition of the of the board's annual report um in terms of those proposed objectives of education you'll notice that these have been rephrased uh along i think just the lines of trying to clarify mostly for format um as we've heard the board reflect the you know to draw your attention um you know a lot of the language will be familiar between the last edition of the comprehensive plan but we have focused in on you know one of the objectives being to partner with parents and families uh of course that being

[04:37:26] a statutory uh command that the general assembly has picked up and we think it reflects this board's concern um so that has been been added into that analysis the proposed priorities and goals um where the real meat is we just want to draw your attention to uh how those uh were were phrased reflective of President Creasy's desire that the the verbs in particular reflect the ongoing nature of the goal so we've set those in the infinitive so each of them are framed as like to set high expectations for every learner to support learning loss recovery to ensure that every k-12 student

[04:38:03] has a high quality licensed teacher and at the board's request as of right now largely mirroring the the department's strategic plan so we've put those before you we are very excited to hear your comments and your thoughts okay ladies and gentlemen this is where we have a discussion so i'll just jump in to say i i do have a number of technical mostly technical edits that i've

[04:38:37] submitted though i will start i'm sorry to say i think those issues are still in this version but i've got some of the page pagination wrong so i can help walk us through that if we need to but there were two that i thought were somewhat substantive one one on my list is the very first one the how do we phrase the goal about setting high expectations for every learner i have a proposed provision for that and then the second one i think is substantive is not on my paper at all but our conversation upstairs just now do we want to add something into the comprehensive plan

[04:39:12] saying that we want to take a look at the funding formula uh going forward but so on my on my um my first substantive one uh what is page in what you were just handed out on page what's numbered page two the paper at the top of the page it says to partner with parents no i'm sorry that's the wrong one excuse me on page nine where it says priorities and goals on what you were just handed

[04:39:48] out and it says to set high expectations for every learner and that language shows up in maybe more than one place here but i would propose an edit to that to say to set and help every learner meet high expectations we don't need to just be setting high expectations setting high expectations is doesn't do any good unless we're trying to help everybody meet them so that's just to set so the language my recommended language be to set and help every learner meet high expectations can we

[04:40:19] have some sort of affirmation by the in the form of a head nod or and then so i do have these other language issues that maybe folks i think everybody i think you have a copy of my memo in your folder if you have questions about them i do have i have to correct some of the page numbers on them so i can help walk through but my suggestion would be that the bigger question that we raised upstairs about do we want to put some language in here about funding formula that's that's more important

[04:40:49] than anything on my email if you want to prioritize discussing it madam president please after yeah so i think some i think some some language polishing that you propose ms holton i think you know like staff to look at those and try to incorporate if we can again make the language more clear i think that's good but i do i do and i don't think we could necessarily write it right now but um i do think we need to add something about our plan to look at to learn about look at and and ultimately make recommendations regarding funding models um i think that that's a big topic

[04:41:29] on the horizon and it definitely needs to fall into the board's work in the uh in the new plan further comments before i we might want to think about which of these oh does it fit under one of these overall headlines or does it need to be a separate one okay i think i mean do we want to

[04:42:04] take each one of these um proposals and agree or disagree on them ask them to be incorporated or not we're talking about the language yes okay i i thought i thought we could move i i think we can trust staff to work on on wordsmithing and and polishing of language i thought we could and this holds the most recent question i'm inclined if it becomes its own new span alone section about funding i think bullets under it could include things like we'd like to receive presentation from jlark we'd like to you know pull some things we'd like to do so i think the

[04:42:40] the funding piece is big enough that it could warrant its own section but i'll defer to my colleagues i'm certainly comfortable with the suggestion uh that we ask staff to look at these wording suggestions and we can revisit next month if needed if there are things they can't resolve okay thank you that's sufficient i think that's a good good starting point uh mr hanson um a little bit of an adult time following uh i don't have paperwork in front of me as such but um i

[04:43:16] think if we're going to talk about funding really also needs to make a deep look at um levels of funding that have been provided how it's been provided and um this you know we've been talking about funding since i was in kindergarten in 1965 with the great society programs and the billions and trillions of dollars that we've spent um try to improve education to

[04:43:44] try to provide equal opportunity um it is just an argument that um i have a difficult time having much sympathy for because it's in my mind where we're spending the money and now our systems are accommodating families and students to get the best results necessary and we're going to go down this pathway i really want to have a comprehensive study of you know what's been done the last three

[04:44:22] years with the um you know uh relief monies over these past three years and you know at the same time of having the most substantial learning loss we've ever had and again you would think there'd be some type of correlation um student improvement when it's actually been just the opposite and so i just um i appreciate and understand the conversation with this but um i think it's been pretty well proven over the last 50 or 60 years but um especially for um i know some of the

[04:45:00] jlr you know surveys came out of maybe where we're positioned against some of our neighboring states and such but it is um uh also well there's academic improvement and where we are i

just uh i really object to you know this conversation that you know more money equals better results because it's um failed time and time again with any federal program on all the state programs and i just i think we ought to be spending our time at looking at you know we're gonna close the

[04:45:39] achievement cap of the learning losses and helping every student succeed in the state and you know money is important but it's not the panacea of i think how it sometimes is positioned to be or so sorry that i'm not following the conversation closely or the the reading the room but i just want to be on record with that thank you anyone else we can give them peace of mind dr northern

[04:46:12] um i'd love just a i don't know if it's a time i think it kind of is a loose timeline um of just the next two years right because who knows what's going to happen in the next two years um none of us do but um what we'd like to get done before you know another administration and so it might be you know a row for data row for standards a row for teacher quality row for special education lab schools all these things we're working on um and we know you know we have x number of meetings between you know now and then and just would just help us um i think orient

[04:46:49] ourselves to all the work that we're trying to get done and loosely when the that work's going to occur and we could start thinking ahead of like we'd like to invite you know somebody in the state to talk to us about x or a national expert talk to us about y and so um just a just more forward um kind of thinking going ahead um because i find that sometimes i just don't know until i get the you know the papers and the documentation of what our plan is for the meeting and it'd be nice to sort of be able to see that out further dr gans dr northing can i clarify that request so you want

[04:47:28] kind of a matrix maybe around the big buckets and when so if innovation is one of the big buckets lab schools will be a focus of December through March's meetings or if teacher pipeline development or elevating educators is one of the buckets that in the comprehensive plan what months are we focusing on that and I think getting out the two years might be hard to talk about outcomes but at least where the rhythm is in the board calendar is that what you're asking it's almost like a Gantt chart you know when are we going to be concentrating on what um and so yeah so we can sort of see like

[04:48:08] because i mean obviously we're talking about some stuff that's going to take some time you know accountability funding um so yeah the extent that we can get some kind of milestones in place like we'd like to have the heavy part of the discussion occur at these months um and then we're going to switch our attention to you know maybe maybe we spend a board meeting talking more in depth about one topic instead of like six because we know next meeting we're going to talk about this other topic in depth and it's just a way to i think also to apportion our time more effectively miss holton

[04:48:46] so i think what you're suggesting is terrific and i think it's essentially what you're asking is that we turn that we have a work plan and we have had that at times in the past and so once we have a comprehensive plan that sets our overall goals then i think it can we can and should ask the department to give us a proposed work plan for the next year or two years and that'll give us some sense of the things that we have to do like the you know the site the seven-year cycle of content standard and fit other things in around that um as to um bill's point bill i'm sorry you weren't able to be with us for lunch upstairs but i i will say i think our discussion is around

[04:49:26] we're really discussing the possibility uh raised up in the jlark report and in the proposed so Q prescriptions that we'll be looking at later today that would Virginia move to a student-based funding formula, weighted student-based funding formula at some point. And that is a separate question in my

mind of whether there would be more money in that formula. In other words, it's regardless of how much money, I mean, and I would be one arguing for more money, certainly, but

[04:49:53] But setting that aside, how the funding is allocated is currently, according to our SOQ funding formula, do we want to make a radical change in that allocation system?

[04:50:09] And I would suggest that what we might want, I heard from our lunchtime discussion, an interest in looking at options for making more significant changes to our funding formula than we can do between now and December when we adopt our SOQs.

[04:50:33] So I'm now working with my pen over here, but one possibility would be to ask the staff to develop for our consideration next month some language on the comprehensive plan. It would go as a bullet under the to set and help every student meet high, every learner meet high expectations that we could add a bullet, something like this.

[04:50:57] consider how to ensure the board's SOQ funding prescriptions support every learner in meeting high expectations. I'm not wedded to my language. I'm just tossing out something. And I think it does fit in under that top priority. We're setting and helping students meet high expectations. Part of that is figuring out whether our funding formula is working toward that end or not. Or are there ways we can make it better work towards that end yeah you know i think i'm struggling with on that

[04:51:34] is is it under or should it be and i'm not wedded this should be its own bullet and and that's um that's what i look at so i'm trying to figure out i agree with the characterization there's two issues here there's amounts and then there's methods um which will be we will need to address uh we'll need to address both but it seems like i mean essentially under all the priorities and goals uh uh efficient and effective finance system is a is going to be a predicate for them in different ways and so i'm not i mean so i hear miss holton's argument for putting it there i think you could almost make that same argument on almost any of the bullets which makes me wonder if we should

[04:52:12] just pull it out as a separate area of of emphasis for us ashton thank you i agree if we're going to make a bold statement and say this is the direction that we think that we should go it should be separate with not any commitment we know it's going to be a process so having a separate bullet specifically around finance because it's comprehensive and it's it's pulling it out it's going to say hey this is important to us down the list correct i think if we say effective and efficient i know there's constitutional language you could refer to that i think we can accommodate

[04:52:49] some of the different concerns that exist around the dais and then the work of the board will be actually resolve that to level of specifics other comments nothing else mr rotherham well i don't want to open a whole can of worms i know there's different views um the partner with parents and families language is it partner or is it served when i read that but i i i do think one of the

[04:53:23] places we got in trouble is is with this uh this idea public schools exist to serve not only parents and families the taxpayers they exist to serve the commonwealth and i feel like sometimes we've had a little bit of confusion about that in ways that hasn't been real productive i'm not wed to it but as i was reading it that was i think that is i know partnership language you obviously want to partner i'm certainly not again i don't really don't be on record that i'm against that obviously but like the underlying mission this is a mission this is a mission of this is a mission of service

[04:53:58] um i mean i do think that that is a pervasive sort of um statement that's been repetitive that we're partnering with um parents and families so i think that's something that i guess it's not a hill to die but i think it's something it's something to consider our orientation i like

[04:54:20] partner are there comments questions i mean we're not having any more all right then madam president can you help what is the process i know this will come back on i feel like there was there's been lots of lively you know um uh i know there's just a sentiment so what's the process so

[04:54:59] we asked the department to draft the plan they've been updating um this plan we've gotten some feedback try to be flexible responsive um but it's the intent of this discussion to provide sort of agreed upon next steps for the department to move into that final phase so that's where i mean obviously some of us might have some differing opinions but at least we can get to an end point in this discussion that we have next steps to give the department clear um and consistent

[04:55:37] guidance on the direction we're going in um so that's sort of where this discussion is headed so if you have anything else speak now or forever hold your peace i'm just kidding dr coons go ahead so my understanding is we're going to incorporate some of the suggestions from and try to reconcile as many as possible we're going to add a funding section that is separate and really talks about a student-based funding formula not necessarily to mr hansen's point about pouring more and more

[04:56:11] money but approaching the funding in a different way to a student-based approach and developing some kind of two-year Gantt chart milestone focused proposed work plan. Would this be for first read in December then? How do you want us to go about the voting process and what is the timeline and line that you want this ready? Ms. Holton? So I would just suggest you know I I generally object to first and final review in one, but this is effectively first review.

[04:56:47] We have a document. So maybe, I don't know, can we declare that we're accepting this draft on first review and then we'd be in a position to do final review next month? We certainly could. That's the will. It wasn't advertised that way, but I think it's clear enough that's what we're doing.

[04:57:03] Do you want us to put it as first and final review in December, or do you want us to put it as just final? Okay, I just want to make sure. I would like the record to reflect that we have accepted this draft on first review today if that's if we need a motion, please.

[04:57:19] Well, we don't normally we don't normally but it's not it but it's not listed on the agenda. So let's let's be real clean. How about that really clean? So let's, since it was not advertised on our agenda as any kind of first review officially, can I have a motion to accept this document for first review?

[04:57:45] No move. Second. Okay. All those in favor, indicate by saying aye. Aye. Those opposed. Okay. If I may just, the one other, Dr. Coulton, the note as to the language on the high expectations for every learner.

[04:58:04] is that i think that one was part of the oh yeah there was an affirmation on that yes yes yeah i have a circle and a check by that one in partner for sure thank you yep thank you for verifying okay so thank you mr chapman for this uh report this uh presentation and to the board for this discussion thank you madam president i have uh some copies i think for the next discussion i'll pan out um and if i might these were made possible by the new board and regulatory liaison for the department ms bryanka white who's sitting over there um just want to make sure you know that

[04:58:39] she'll be with our team now thank you all right okay and so we are moving to item c and once again i'd like to express my gratitude to the board for your extensive feedback and comments on the annual report we received feedback from four of our board members and then over the past month and then more recently as we've gotten closer to this this meeting superintendent and i have reviewed that feedback and incorporated feedback that represented comments from the majority of our board meeting our board members over the last meeting i do appreciate the diligence that the board

[04:59:18] takes in reviewing everything very carefully as we prepare for our board meetings to ensure that we meet the deadlines that are required of us um and so um i just want to give you all my appreciation for that because this is critical work that needs to be accomplished so with that dr coons i can hand this over to you um i just want to echo your thanks we had tremendous feedback and incorporation of comments around the annual report and lots of discussion and lots of robust

[04:59:57] ads around data, components that preceded my collaboration with the board. So appreciate some of those add-ins and things that were important to others. So I don't have a specific report since we talked so deeply last month and happy to take any questions or comments on the annual report. Ms. Hulton. Just to note, yes, thank you for taking such care with our suggestions uh some of the suggestion is there some language in the comprehensive plan

[05:00:36] as you know that now mirrors the annual report if we make changes in the comprehensive plan language we should may i suggest that when we come back here next month those changes also be reflected in the annual report draft um just asking for guidance on the board since the annual report is due december 1st our plan was to submit after this board meeting so oh well i didn't understand that because it isn't on for first or final review today i thought you were planning to submit it in december late i recognize that it is due now but yeah that that is an error on the

[05:01:13] agenda for sure so happy to do the do the will of the board on the annual report well i i will say i i think there are some things that there are some things in it that still need cleanup as in the conference of plan so whether we can and what would you like to voice those specific things so that we can i would have i'd have to go back and look but they were technical to clean up things still but i'm sorry i can't i can't point to them so not but i just didn't i i was not on notice that we were trying to adopt the annual report today absolutely it's due by december 1st but i

[05:01:52] thought that the what i had understood when we changed put out this agenda certainly to adapt to the will of board certainly happy to dr siebert um you know if there are technical edits um you have capacity if the board members provide them to you uh to to do that i mean as long as it's not you know um it's not it's not substantive i think i'm okay empowering the president superintendent to again polish it up is that i think that would be the best approach yeah i have a specific amendment

[05:02:31] madam president on the just make sure to incorporate the action we took on the lab schools this morning which obviously couldn't be incorporated so some things like that which are definitely technical corrections but we need some updates sure so i am remembering i think this has not yet been addressed in the annual report drafts before us if i may the uh where we describe what we did on accountability and accreditation there is a list of we've decided to go forward with proposed consider proposed proposed revisions on achievement index readiness index and overall

[05:03:09] the growth measure is left out okay and i'm sure that was just inadvertent because we did go forward on all of those so i know where that i know what page number that is on the comprehensive plan

but i don't remember what the page number is on the annual report another is and this one isn't quite so technical but i do think that the annual report should include language referencing the two jlark reports under the staffing vacancy section, there should be reference to the JLARC report that came

[05:03:47] out in September on staffing shortages and in the SOQ prescription section. And I did put language in here on the comprehensive plan, comfortable language, but the board has also reviewed and considered JLARC's July 2023 report on Virginia's K-12 funding formula and the recommendations container. Those were two very big events this year in the Commonwealth that should be noted in our annual report. So I struggle to specifically point out JLARC with the vacancies issue because

[05:04:27] that's huge. I mean, that's well known. And the actual data that's kept is kept here, although their report is reflective of some of our data. I mean, I think we can note it as an ongoing thing.

[05:04:43] I hate to stop at that one point of the JLARC study and not realizing that it is a continual and ongoing hurdle that we will have to be crossing. And the language that I've suggested on the comprehensive plan, you know, we added that into the annual court. I think that would be consistent with your, what you just said. Okay. I think, quite honestly, that's my only concern with talking about jlark's report to begin with is because some of those things that were

[05:05:16] pointed out are ongoing and continual and continue to grow as some issues and so stopping at their point maybe doesn't really emphasize it enough if you follow where i'm going with that can i just ask a question so miss holton you're saying that the board considered the jlark you just want to line in both the funding and in the staffing and i have recommended language in the email

[05:05:49] that i said about how brings a plan that would address both of those all right i was just asking for clarification madam president thank you and then the addition of those lab the lab schools and the growth there's one other in both the plan and the annual report that others may not i'll just note for the record that i would ask that the annual report delete the language referring to and students whose schools were closed the longest in the uh under the paragraph

[05:06:25] on student performance i think the evidence that students whose schools were closed the longest had failed more than others i think the evidence on that is at best weak at the national level and on completely not valid at the state level but um i'll just note that objection for the record and i think there are probably significant differences in opinion on that so my understanding is we have data on that we have seen the data and it's not i don't think it's valid but i'm not suggesting it's worth our spending a time a long time here on a discussion about it so i'll

[05:07:03] just note for the record mr rotherham are you asking us to reference the data in that line i think if that makes people more comfortable yeah i mean there is my my understanding i'm happy to be corrected but that there is there is data that uh strongly suggests that the virginia data is based on very small numbers in the longest closed divisions and it does not account for poverty the national studies that have looked at this when they accounted for poverty the differences went away that would be my concern okay um i'd like to jump back to where you were

[05:07:40] trying to point out where growth wasn't noted yeah i know where it is in the annual report in the in the uh on the comprehensive plan because i'm looking at the annual report right now on page six the board has initiated a regulatory change to split the accreditation accountability model and design an outcome-based accountability model grounded in student growth student achievement and student

readiness and then does it go on to when it goes on to say that the board is advancing proposed revisions on xyz but it leaves it out there i think okay let's just make sure that those

[05:08:19] sync up please further comments seeing none um we would like to go ahead with the first review officially and we will you guys it's the will of this board that we do superintendent and i will work on the final product based on these right based on the recommendation does that mean we're

[05:08:51] doing first and final review well again this is due on december the first well i just i mean i don't think it's fair to the public i don't think it's fair to the public to do first and final review when we haven't shared this draft with anybody and put them on notice that it was going to be first and final review today and on the other hand i don't know what to do with that because you're right it's due by december 1st and this is why we should have had among other things a two-day meeting but here we are okay mr rotherham person what are our options i mean can we can we formally notice that we are going to submit it on our next meeting i think is the 11th or the

[05:09:31] 12th um that's 10 days what what are what are what are our options here because i i i do agree we want to we want to meet our deadlines we want to be transparent to the public and we do have a truncated uh meeting unfortunately this week so i don't understand how a truncated meeting would change this since i mean we're happy to do this for our first line first there's no way we could have made those revisions by tomorrow for you to review um there's just not capacity of the staff and i just want to make that statement to the board like doing things overnight between the first and second day makes errors happen and we want to make sure we get you a good draft so we're

[05:10:08] more than happy to put this for um final make this a first review and put this for final review and notify that we will have the annual report on December 13th or December by the end of that week if that is the will of the board. I think we should go that direction if everybody is okay with that. That seems like the least bad option with where we are because I do think I take the point I'm not rushing. I do think we could have sequenced this better and I think it's important that we get this out as quickly as possible and if we're going to miss the deadline that we hope in the spirit of accountability we notice that and hold ourselves accountable for that. Our

[05:10:43] assignment's late we might lose a few points okay you can't you can't get less than a 50 now right okay so um for the purposes of moving on here um so today we will um accept this on first review and then we will we will have final review on this in december do you want to do this the same you did the comprehensive plan yes please um so we will go ahead and take a motion on accepting

[05:11:16] this for first review since it was not on the agenda as such so moved second all those all those in favor indicate by saying all opposed okay we will take this for final review in december thank you okay um do we need to take a quick break or yes can we please take a quick break

[05:11:45] we'll do five minutes please maybe ten um so i'd like to open this item um wait is dr really doing

[05:22:01] that one right now no no no i just don't need to forget that item okay um we are doing item d and so dr raley is here i want to open by thanking the department for the extensive work and drafting of the prescriptions following the agreed upon steps that was provided by the board at our last meeting and at our last meeting if you'll remember Dr. Ramley and Dr. Myers presented the results of the

superintendent survey which informed some of the prescriptions that we have in this draft and we spent a lot of time discussing those the prior prescriptions and narrowed our focus by

[05:22:41] asking the department to draft five prescriptions so first we asked the department to craft something on flexibility in that um on the student weighted funding formula and i believe that board members might have some additional recommendations or discussion points here two we had a lot of discussion around the virginia literacy act and learning loss and talked about some of that critical area of need during our annual report discussion where we outlined a lot of that discussion in the comprehensive plan and the reviewing of soq data and we did agree that we

[05:23:16] should provide extended funding for these needs we're looking to to additional discussions in december and the department's initial on the department's initial draft this draft has flexibility so that we can have some more conversation about what we think this prescription should fund around the literacy act and learning loss number three we asked the department to write something that focused on work-based learning opportunities and high school barriers so thank you to the department for getting that to us and and get us started early on that in this draft

[05:23:56] we know this is going to be an area significant conversation today um from the email feedback that we have received from many of you we also discussed the need for a prescription around teacher pipeline and thank you again to the department for that initial material that we have been provided here for our consideration and i'm sure we'll have lots of questions and comments here as well but the last meeting um we had multiple board members that discussed the need to create narrow and tight a narrow and tight list of prescriptions rather than a long

[05:24:33] menu of offerings and we also discussed that opportunity of flexibility of funding so in addition on friday november 10th i think miss holton asked for information on the at risk add-on vla funding and grow your own cost analysis analysis so several additional asks were made of the department the last two days i think some of those have come to us some of those may take a little bit longer than just the time that was provided. But the department will post these

[05:25:07] reports to the website following our meeting. And as we agreed in our last meeting, we will vote on final prescriptions in December. Therefore, today we need to be making final decisions so the department can hone this draft, revise, and prepare the final prescriptions for us to vote on next month. So all of that being said, I will hand over to Dr. Raley to provide us a little bit of an update and some discussion. Thank you. Thank you, President Creasy. I appreciate the introduction.

[05:25:40] And as you mentioned, this is one step along the way on an iterative process that ultimately will end on your opportunity to make final decisions at your December meeting. So our goal for today is to present you with some prescriptions for your consideration simply as a place to get started as a result of the conversation that you had last month and as a result of some additional feedback that we received from stakeholders so just for the benefit of the public and our audience that is watching online just wanted to go back in time just a moment to last month's board meeting where we shared with you information that we received from superintendents we had pretty strong representation from superintendents across the commonwealth where we asked them to rank

[05:26:20] the 2019 prescriptions in order of need as well as identifying emerging trends and emerging needs now we are in 2023 so that was part of the data that you received at that meeting and ultimately informed your conversation last month as reference in the introduction there were some themes that

resonated from your conversation last month here are some of those that were referenced including flexibility and funding the need for supporting literacy work-based learning and educator pipeline development last month the board expressed interest in hearing from additional stakeholders including

[05:26:54] families teachers school board members and others with the vested interest in this important action by the board and so since last meeting uh dr coons and i had the chance to spend some time with the virginia school boards association had a chance to meet with their executive leadership and representative school board members from across the commonwealth we also had a chance to meet with elementary and secondary principals through the advisory committee that we support as well as regional teachers of the year and so i had an opportunity to hear directly from them about their voice on this important matter what was important to them and certainly that has informed

[05:27:29] some of the recommendations for your consideration today in addition we have a teacher survey that has been published publicly as well as a parent survey and as i will share with you today that survey is still in process and not yet final but i can provide some of those themes and updates to you later on as we go throughout the process so parent survey was administered earlier this month and as of 11-9 which was last week we did have some a fair amount of respondents 612 and as you can expect we're going to get more between now and the 22nd of november when ultimately this survey will close and as we prepare for your december meeting we'll have a full update on the information

[05:28:09] that we received from our parents there were some themes that i just wanted to recognize that came out through the initial early results and that's being an emphasis on daily student attendance and the importance of daily student attendance as well as recognizing the great work that happens in classrooms across the commonwealth celebrating the effective and highly classroom teachers that serve students here in virginia there were some references to a few things that concern our families based on these early results including the need for school counselors and support for our students our teachers we had a pretty strong response rate initially and we'll continue to

[05:28:46] analyze these results over time but some of the information that came from the teacher survey as issues that we we wanted to share today that's including the need for teacher recruitment and retention focusing on the staff who are currently working in our schools as well as those who are considering our career in education and identifying strategies make sure that we have a teacher pipeline to inform the future work and then some areas of strength that were referenced again was recognizing the value and support of our staff and recognizing the great work teachers do that's been recognized not only by teachers but also as our parents as i previously referenced and then

[05:29:23] an area of concern is recognizing the need that we still have an ever-changing student body with unique individual concerns and needs and so ultimately recognizing that there's additional supports that may be needed for students as we go forward so all that That information, combined with what we shared with you last month and the information that we have early in this process, informs some of the work that we as staff did to prepare some recommendations today.

[05:29:49] Ultimately, for your consideration, this is a board action, and ultimately you will decide what you want to do between now and final vote in December. So we've prepared six recommended prescriptions for consideration. Again, a conversation point to get started.

[05:30:04] you do have additional information in your packet with a lot of backup and support related to how these prescriptions were generated by staff but ultimately are presented again for your consideration

the first specifically references flexible funding and this was a theme that did come through in conversations whether it was a school board member or a teacher recognizing that one student is one student and that we have 1.3 million children in this commonwealth all with unique and individualized needs and recognizing that there's an opportunity to challenge the status quo with our traditional funding formula recognizing that that was built for a different

[05:30:40] point in time and that there's an opportunity to think differently about how we can transition from a resource-based funding formula with staff ratios to one that recognizes the unique and individual different needs of a student so this recommendation for your consideration includes the establishment of a student-weighted funding formula for the purposes of determining how state and local funding shares are considered as the cost for public education in the commonwealth the second prescription again relates to flexibility that seems to be a continued theme in a conversation

[05:31:15] and this one specifically references literacy and the expansion of the work that is currently being done to meet the unique needs of students from an instructional standpoint this is not formula driven this is flexible funding that would be utilized to meet the unique needs of students so this specifically references the work that we are doing as an agency and across the commonwealth regarding literacy and numeracy and expands those opportunities for students with some academic flexible funding the third prescription for your consideration today and moving forward specifically rates relates to work-based learning and high school redesign now i think there are some

[05:31:54] in key points that i wanted to pull out of this potential prescription for your consideration this would be a prescription that recommends the general assembly requires that high school students have the opportunity to pursue their own individualized academic and career-based experiences experiences being a key word here recognizing that students as they go through their academic career need to learn by doing rather than reading or watching the video but how can we prepare students through experiences that they truly have during their academic career and then recognized industry credentials meaningful industry credentials would be a

[05:32:33] part of this prescription and making sure that students have a meaningful experience along that way accomplishing this through a couple ways work-based learning experience and then allowing local school divisions again that have flexible scheduling and flexible seat time to ensure that all students all students are able to participate in a credentialing program that prepares them for what life may be for them after high school the next prescription board members is specifically related to special education and this is an opportunity for us to have greater consistency

[05:33:07] across the commonwealth and this specifically references the need and the desire for us to have an iep program that we can utilize across the commonwealth in all school divisions this will increase transparency for our families it'll allow us as an agency to have greater visibility of the work that is happening in local school divisions and ultimately deploy resources where we may need them for monitoring and support for local school divisions so in today's world where we need to have greater access to data this is certainly a way of increasing transparency allowing us to dedicate the resources to where they need and ultimately providing a better experience for our

[05:33:46] students and our families along the way next this recommendation aligns with educator pipeline development and specifically relates to some of the data that we saw in our survey last month and some conversations that continue to be had here in the commonwealth and this is setting an expectation

for local school divisions that have a teacher vacancy rate of more than three percent based on the positions and exit collection data those school divisions with that vacancy rate per this prescription would implement will implement and maintain a teacher apprenticeship program to allow them to provide low cost no cost options for individuals in their community who are invested in

[05:34:26] their community who want to be teachers but may have some barriers this is requiring them to use a teacher apprenticeship program to allow them to provide a stronger pipeline of workforce for their local schools and the last prescription for your consideration as you move forward specifically relates to data and board members it's been said in multiple settings and i'll say it again today that as an agency and it's really challenging for us to make real-time data-driven decisions when we do not have access to the data currently in virginia to collect data from local school

[05:35:02] divisions it's an event that takes place that requires a whole lot of resources both on the school division side and on our side as an agency and here we are in 2023 utilizing a system that was developed in 1999 and a whole lot has happened with technology since that time so we are truly running an archaic system here in virginia and so as we are nimble and need to make quick decisions to benefit students and families in the commonwealth we don't have the data to make those decisions and so we are delayed in action and getting great things done for public education as a result

[05:35:38] of of this this lack of data so this prescription does include asking recommending to the general assembly the appropriate funding to purchase a statewide student information system and certainly there would be benefit to local school divisions and us that would be long term over the next several years from a personnel standpoint and just an overall cost standpoint so certainly a positive thing here for many the board members you have access to these prescriptions i know many of you have perspectives on this but ultimately wanted to share our thoughts as staff for your consideration to again give you something to react to today and we do have some content experts if

[05:36:15] needed to answer any questions you may have thank you dr raley yes ma'am dr coons i i just want to add um you said that we did some of those i want to give a huge shout out to the staff because these are probably have been all the staff has done for the past three days is the grow your own calculations the at-risk add-on and the virginia literacy act and the calculations and the dig in so you do have additional data per miss holton's request to um think through some of these pieces so i do want to really let you guys know that we stopped all holds barred to get these things to you but

[05:36:50] they have spent a lot of time pulling data making sure the data as dr raley said from an archaic system as complete and accurate as the data we have available this is very responsive um i do have a couple of questions dr raley um and this may kind of be more of a discussion point but first i wanted to ask you on the parent survey i know we may not have gone any deeper than just kind of what's what is a kind of a superficial area of concern but do we know um in the third area of

[05:37:26] concern one in three at this time said that if their child needed additional academic assistance their child's school is unable to provide that do we know whether it's an issue of human resources or if it's an issue of scheduling and how are we i mean is there an opportunity for us to provide something that that builds some sort of mechanism to support either one of those pieces you know one of the things that we will definitely tease out as we go between now and december is getting

[05:38:04] really in depth in the data this is a high level review knowing that the survey was rather immature so as we analyze that we have the ability to ask some questions that will drive some of those

decisions based on board conversation what's the data that's important to the board and how can we provide that and so that's something we can certainly look into deeper as we analyze the data in the future that i think would be important sort of to know like where are we are we not putting the human resources there are they not there or is it a you know a sheer matter of the fact that there's not enough hours in the day or second thing um i just wanted to touch on

[05:38:41] was um on the teacher survey um where where you were talking about the issue of recruitment and retention you know i know that we talk a lot about class size reduction but inevitably if we had ongoing very successful recruitment to fill vacancies then we wouldn't be also talking about class size reduction as much as we do. But that's something too that maybe this is a kind of a dual

[05:39:17] question or a dual comment because I know Dr. Northern has quite a bit of expertise in this area as a national researcher. But what is the data out there? I mean, is class size reduction such a huge deal or is that offset inevitably very strongly by that ongoing recruitment and successful recruitment? So, um, the class size research, I mean, honestly, it pays off most in K3, which is where we have it. Um, but the best, um, you know, teachers like small classes. I will say that. I mean, I'm a former teacher. I like class, small classes. It's very popular with

[05:39:57] parents and, um, and teachers. Um, unfortunately it's the, it's a fade out. So the Perry preschool is the, you know, is the famous sort of study on class size. It's been cited gazillions of times because it has a rigorous study design. But they do find out even the best studies on class size do find that the impacts on those kids fade out, usually by fifth grade. So it's not that it's not good. It's just that those impacts don't tend to stick around for those kids long term.

[05:40:32] Miss Ashton? I think it's less about class size versus school size and that's it goes to relationships particularly with middle school then going on to high school which all boils down to a relationship and so I think that's right at the early ages where those foundational reading math skills are so important class size does matter but it's really school size and relationships

[05:41:00] And if I might add the question you asked about what are teachers saying about being able to provide those interventions, it really reminds me of the conversation we're having around the science of reading and standards, because we're having this exact same problem at my school, which is you have a kid, a kid's a non-reader, or they're two, three, four grade levels behind, and you've got 19, 20 kids in the class.

[05:41:30] classroom, and there's not enough reading specialists, not enough therapists, there's not enough anyone to really meet that kid where they are. So it's both a talent pipeline, but it is a skill gap in terms of teachers being able to say you've got a fifth grader, but they're four grades behind, but you got to keep them in the same grade because you don't want to lower the bar.

[05:41:53] So it just, it's the science of reading. It's the standards, how we all continue to close the gaps. It's not going to close the gaps at once. So I'm just saying all of that towards like the great work we're doing around standards and accountability are going to allow those gaps to close over time and not, you know, the pressure of one year you've got to get on track. That's just not possible.

[05:42:20] So the last thing that I just wanted to ask about is on the work-based learning prescription, it talks about upon graduation, all students should earn an industry-recognized credential.

[05:42:36] Do we want to say that should or do we want to say may or where are we on that? Is that Dr. Armstrong? Sorry, Dr. Armstrong, I'm making you happy. Thank you for letting the subject matter experts weigh in.

[05:42:56] Absolutely. Thank you, Madam President. I would suggest that our intent in our draft of this prescription is to ensure that a student has a high-quality work-based learning experience. The understanding is that if a student achieves an IRC, an industry-recognized credential, through the list that we're now filtering through to make that meaningful, they will have established that.

[05:43:19] So if you're not on a path to necessarily earn a meaningful industry-recognized credential, then you would have an opportunity to engage in some type of work-based learning exposure, whether you're an advanced diploma student at a core university or you're going to community college or going straight to the workplace.

[05:43:36] Sounds good. So I think May would suffice. May would suffice. Okay. I mean, would that be the will of the board to move, should, to May or May? See, sorry. My wondering, Jeremy, could you put that language back up so we could wordsmith it a little bit together? I'm actually wondering, Dr. Armstrong, if it should be industry-recognized credential or meaningful work-based learning experience. So is it one of those? Yes. Okay. It's not necessarily an industry-recognized credential only. It's having... I think that's how I read it.

[05:44:15] Yeah. I think we've had a lot of conversations with our superintendents. I think we've had this conversation with VSBA in the listening session, that we have a lot of kiddos on advanced tracks who get to college or are filling out applications and have literally no work-based understanding. And so I think the feedback was to have some kind of work-based experience, whether it's a seminar, whether it's something that all students have the opportunity to experience to help them. So that was the conversation on this. But this is, again, you asked us to draft something. We're happy to take feedback and directionality from the board. Mr. Rotherham. So, Madam President, I'm a little

[05:44:53] confused. I thought the missing words were upon graduation, if you've done this, you should have the opportunity for the credential, not that all students should. And are we now saying that everyone should have this period or that the opportunity, I read it as require high school students have the opportunity, which means that all divisions should offer this but not that all students necessarily need to participate i read this in more of a more in more of a choice flavor miss holton just your your if it's the opportunity version that's already the law in virginia that's so that's okay so we are stepping it up

[05:45:32] if we choose if we want to step it up we would have to go it's already the place that high schools are required to give all students an opportunity for workplace learning i just threw throw out my issues or ideas. So I don't know if we're going one by one. Is that how you want to organize it? It's fine. Yes. Okay. So for this one, so I'm concerned that a work-based learning experience could just be anything. I don't know how much we're going to put any kind of guidelines around that. A seminar is all well and good, but I don't know, is a seminar going to be our best

[05:46:11] use of time? I guess it depends on what the seminar has in it. I'm with you on industry recognized credentials. The biggest credential we've talked about before is on OSHA and for CPR. I mean, state after state after state after state, that's always what the two top IRCs are. So we're going to have to do something about that. And so I would suggest maybe we widen it to it's, you know, IRCs, it could be dual

enrollment courses, because then that's going to set you up for, you know, an AA degree or, you know, going on to a four-year if you want.

[05:46:47] It could be apprenticeships. I would actually love to see that word used because we want high quality apprenticeships. And it could also be military readiness. I'm trying to think as we're talking big picture about our, you know, accountability buckets that we've been talking about, readiness, you know, we tie into those readiness conversations we've been having.

[05:47:08] So I guess I wanted to see it a little bit more broad to talk not only about IRCs or, know and a little bit more specific instead of just this whatever this experience is going to be that we name dual enrollment college credits apprenticeships and military readiness like so maybe you pass the asvab or something like that yes or that if i may madam president you captured several of the elements of the early post-secondary opportunities and then what we've really been discussing is we've been exploring high school redesign and i think your first point to that really what is considered a high quality work-based learning experience and when we drafted this the

[05:47:45] thought was that the work-based learning can be the connective tissue you're taking these isolated silos of content and what experience can really galvanize that for when you graduate you have a better understanding what it is you want to go into or at least what it is that's ahead of you the conversation i had anecdotally with a staff member recently that dr tunes alluded to is that his son top student local high school Virginia Tech application check school of engineering he wants to go into data science doesn't need to go to school of engineering but he doesn't have that awareness not by anybody's fault he doesn't have that exposure so I think this really the the nucleus of this uh proposed prescription is that that work-based learning experience and I

[05:48:24] think we weave it into everything else again that you mentioned there but for the purpose of this I think we take that we flesh it out with some of the things you mentioned too okay I honestly I I just didn't want them to, I mean, lots of times as humans, we take the easy way out, right? And so I just, I don't want that box checked with a seminar that all kids sit in and learn about.

[05:48:45] I don't know what, you know. Please, thank you for clarifying it, that bucket, that phrase captures so many of these other things. I also want to mention, the Secretary of Education was here a couple months ago, and we talked a little bit about this. We are working with Secretary Slater and multiple spaces about the industry recognized credential work in Virginia and making that to high wage, high demand and a much more coherent list because we have heard similar feedback to what you're speaking to.

[05:49:17] But as we all are going out to do listening sessions on accountability and accreditation, I just want to remind everybody that we are definitely looking at the industry-recognized credentials and making sure they are actually meaningful opportunities for our students and that they're something that lead towards a high-wage, high-demand job.

[05:49:37] Please, Dr. Siebert. i just want to lift up for us as we watch this move through the general assembly and this second part about flexible scheduling and sleep time that that's got to be there you can't do the first part in the same 180 days um seven hours and 20 minutes we we can't require the first part if we're not going to provide relief on the time constraints in the second part so i just i like the conversation i like the flavor and the direction but we just have we can't let these two become decoupled

[05:50:11] other comments i have a on this topic or just no i just want to make sure that we have clear direction since we're coming back with final read next month so on this prescription i want to make sure the the department has a clear direction from the board on revisions so help me understand what we're revising and what we're doing so that we don't get stuck between now and

[05:50:49] December. I mean, on my comment, I'm sorry, I would just like some examples of work-based learning experience as we've talked about that could just be in the parens such as blah, blah, blah, blah, blah, blah. That would be enough, I think, for me. Okay. Any other comments on this particular prescription? And then we took it out of order. Sorry, that was my fault. No worries. Okay. Let's

[05:51:17] go to prescription one please all right comments i do have a question miss holton so this item is basically meant to continue oh no i'm sorry i thought we were on to the next one time no we went back we went back to the first one because i went out of turn and took three first yeah and we did discuss this one at lunch and i'm all supportive of dr siebert's proposed language

[05:51:46] revision but as perhaps amended by um mr rotherhams but i do think that uh we need to recognize and acknowledge our constitutional obligation to set the standards of quality and therefore would suggest that while we're not today ready to announce a student-based weighted or in december a student-based weighted funding formula, that we begin a process of exploring a student-based funding formula with the anticipation that we'll be able to make some prescriptions one way or the

[05:52:25] other on that during the 2024 calendar year. Mr. Rotherham, were you going to make a comment? No, but I'm happy to. No, I was referring to you based on, you know, the language that I put forward in our kind of conversation there yeah i mean so i'm looking at i'm looking at the language i would like to see um if we don't want to say establish if we're not comfortable saying that then i would like to see something pretty affirmative like continue taking steps towards establishing you know we understand there's going to be a committee and so forth i just want to make sure like unless people believe you use the word enthusiastically i'd be fine with putting i don't know if we use

[05:53:02] enthusiastically in the actual policy but um uh something that like makes clear this this board's unambiguous support for moving that direction unless that support is indeed ambiguous dr sievert um so my only concern about continuing steps is i'm not sure what steps the gentleman is doing right now i know when they first thing was when they received the jlark study they weren't created committee to look at it so i'm not sure what steps they've taken so my my current draft language would be that the board of education recommend the general sem that recommends the general assembly committee reviewing this assumes they have a committee reviewing that's our understanding

[05:53:39] that the committee reviewing the jlark study recommendations investigate model and develop a plan to migrate toward a student weighted funding formula the idea being that they would again we gotta we gotta learn more about it um and they need to then we also every legislator every superintendent every board would see it modeled for their district see what it looks like and then based on that that would develop a plan to migrate toward my only concern is tying it to that committee rather than charging the general assembly more directly with do anything the committees that's certainly a part of it and and we want to make sure we don't so it could be just the general assembly review the jlark studies investigate model and develop a plan it's very

[05:54:19] going to do through their committee yeah what you're going to do through their committee yeah exactly yeah exactly okay I'm sorry I just wanted to highlight copy paste to do this so um okay I got it

you got it yep all right anybody else have a comment on this or is is everybody could you read it back to us um the board of education recommends the general assembly I guess it

[05:54:55] should be committee reviewing the JLARC study recommendations, consider migrating to a student weighted funding formula. I think that's not it. Madam President, I think where we ended up was the Board of Education recommend the General Assembly review the JLARC study recommendations, investigate, model, and develop a plan to migrate toward a student weighted funding formula.

[05:55:23] Was that in your last email? No, this is a little different based on what Mr. Rotherham and I have been working on. Okay. Can you tell me, Dr. Northern, can you tell me how the JLARC report, I know the JLARC report recommended that, you know, is that why the JLARC is in there?

[05:55:41] Because there's a ton of stuff in the JLARC. So I'm trying to decide whether we really need that whole bit about JLARC, except just to point out the JLARC also recommended it, which I think is what you're trying to do. Is that right? And again, I'm not sure what's happening, changing since election.

[05:55:57] But that both parties in both chambers indicated upon receipt of the JLARC study that they were going to create a committee to review it. So I was looking at it as a way that this is what they said they were going to do. We would be hitching this language to that wagon. But again, I'm certainly open to that.

[05:56:14] And my concern is that I don't want to hitch to any particular wagon except the General Assembly. I think this is a big opportunity for the Commonwealth. with so it sounds like we're i'm sure anybody watching is like why are they arguing over these words but like this is a big opportunity for the commonwealth and i'd like to see this board commit that we we want the general assembly to move in this direction these committees do it great but i don't want us tied to it and and not just move towards i would like to see us say move to a system the way it awaited students why we deleted the word committee from this line okay well i would just say i mean the jailer thank you the jailer report laid out a thoughtful

[05:56:52] consideration of this issue and put it out there for consideration and the general assembly has taken that up already so you know it gives a lot more meat to our recommendation helps people understand what we're talking about if we reference the j-lock report yeah i'm i'm fine with you the j-lock report and it's more i don't want to be anchored to the committee madam i'm just a little confused because and maybe i haven't looked at the j-lock report closely enough but 70 of the the JLAC report is about staffing allocations. And then 20% is, hey, by the way, at the end,

[05:57:31] we should really be looking into the student base. So it's really sending two different messages if we just say JLAC report, because JLAC report is operating in the old system, just like we are, as it's advising that we step into, you know, 2023. So I just want to make sure if we're going to reference a JLAC report that we're not talking about adopting, you know, all of these 70 pages worth of staffing allocations we're talking about the recommendation that we move ahead and consider a new model well and also to me jlark reports highlight needs that the general assembly may

[05:58:06] want to address may just like they may want to address our soqs um so dr coons i i have amazing staff who just copied and pasted the language so the chairs the house appropriations and senate finance and appropriations committee shall each appoint up to five members from their respective committees to a joint subcommittee on elementary and sub-secondary education funding to provide

[05:58:39] oversight team stop texting me i can't read while it's moving um to provide oversight and ongoing direction of the standards of quality fund funding cost policies and to make recommendations to

their respective committees so that's what they have been they're supposed to review the recommendations from jlark determine the appropriateness of implementing each recommendation or policy option and propose appropriate amendments and develop a long-range plan for phased implementation

[05:59:15] of its recommendations thanks kent that would be the committee that was established to review correct that's the language for that committee exactly what they're supposed to do and president And I think Dr. Borland's concern was that within that, we'd want to lift up the student-weighted funding formula piece.

[05:59:36] Right. Yes, and mine is an and. Like, in no way, I think this committee is great, and I hope that in the forward expedition thing comes out with something great, but that the board institutionally just make a broader endorsement of this, regardless of what happens, I think.

[05:59:52] So I want to make sure we don't do anything in any way somehow impugns that committee or that we don't value it. The opposite is the case, but just also makes the broader charge to the legislature that this is the direction we think we should go. Do we all believe we need to end that, or do we believe we need to be broader?

[06:00:11] And, I mean, I would side with Mr. Rotherham that it needs to be a broader opportunity rather than one that could potentially be derailed by not seeing outcomes within that committee.

[06:00:29] But what's the will of the board? My only thing, I think this is wordsmithing that we can ask the staff to help us on, but the specific language we want to make sure is included is the student-based weighted funding formula.

[06:00:46] That phrase has to be, should be in there. And move two, are we agreed? Move two, are we? Well, I'd like to Allen's consider a plan. Please. My original issue with what's on the screen was establish. Right.

[06:01:01] I just thought we were too soon to say we're directing established. And that's where it was the idea of investigate, model, and develop a plan to migrate. To migrate to? Yeah. Okay. Toward.

[06:01:19] there's a lot of distance and often what sometimes happens is we then get the very uh light version rather than yeah okay um so are we all in agreement on this one and are capable of letting um the department wordsmith it to they know that our what our direction is here so can we move to prescription two thanks all right comments on this prescription i have a question miss holton

[06:01:51] This is the one that essentially is meant to include something like the flexible funds that the General Assembly gave the divisions this year that's being used for tutoring, chronic absenteeism, et cetera.

[06:02:09] This is meant to include something like that in the SOQs on an ongoing basis. is that okay so i'm i'm curious as to how you how the department's recommendation i think has a 25 million dollar price tag next to this one is that right yes i i think i'm happy to collaborate with dr rayleigh i think that was an option we are more than willing to have the board discuss on other options but wanted a placeholder in that space so i just would say and it may be you know maybe we We need language to be more specific at.

[06:02:45] It's sufficient to meet the needs of students for tutoring or something. But the current funding is $418 million across three needs. But the department has recommended that I think 70% of it goes to

tutoring, high-intensity tutoring.

[06:03:02] So that's $300 million or so. It differs by a factor of 10 from the $25 million. And I'm not clear whether they're both annual figures or biannual figures. So help us on the numbers on that one. I think we saw that at minimum it would need to be $25 million to continue the ongoing needs.

[06:03:22] But wouldn't $25 million be, $25 million wouldn't continue what we're currently finding with $300 million? Correct. Expecting that some of our students would be doing better at the end of the year. 90%? We are more than willing to take any advisement in the board.

[06:03:40] We just felt like $25 million would be the floor to continue what we're seeing in all-in spending plans. I just think that this is a flexibility piece. And we all say we like this and the enhanced at-risk add-on, which we'll get to later, are the two most flexible funds for divisions.

[06:03:59] Dr. Siebert? This might be, Dr. Cairns, a question for your content expert, a.k.a. Kent Dickey. And my question on this flexible piece is just how, if we endorse a flexible approach, how does flexible funds impact or not impact re-benchmarking?

[06:04:21] Because, you know, I just think it's important that if we create opportunities for funding that school divisions use and make use of, that in the next cycle of re-benchmarking, the fact that those funds were used be part of that process. So I just want to do it. I'm just curious. I'm curious. I think maybe the board would be curious on what's in re-benchmarking, what's out, so that we'll inadvertently create an important funding stream that doesn't get re-benchmarked based on inflation and other factors.

[06:04:52] Yes, that is a concern. As you well know now, the current methodology, re-benchmarking, what we're going through right now, it does account for student enrollment growth or decline, inflationary adjustments that are recognized, adjustments to head count or student counts in some of the student needs areas that are incorporated in some of the funding streams, uh such as esl special ed of course and others and so that that that same you know recognition

[06:05:31] of cost change due to enrollment inflation special you know special student needs populations that would still need to occur with a you know weighted student formula some some way um to make sure it's keeping pace with you know what's uh reality in the in the school division so i think some of the and you were around a long time at uh mr siebert in the school divisions for re-benchmarkings saw many of those i think some of the same issues will surface and and need to be attended to an

[06:06:04] accountant for dr siebert so um and just help me so using the current flexible funds that came out in the september budget um are those funds looking ahead to the next re-benchmarking will they be reflected the benchmarking or because they were separate and flexible would they be outside the the re-benchmarking. That's what I was getting at in terms of here if we create a new flexible pot. Yeah, and of course, those are outside of the SOQ or re-benchmarking. I mean, those were one-time appropriations, you know, to address, you know, current learning loss and student needs,

[06:06:39] chronic absenteeism, the other designated areas. But so they would not continue in the re-benchmark base because at least for now, those were intended to be, you know, one-time infusion.

[06:06:54] Just a minute. So, Mr. Dickey, if so, considering re-benchmarking, talk to us a little bit about how putting an at-risk add-on piece into the SOQs will affect re-benchmarking.

[06:07:17] That formula currently is re-benchmarked. It has re-benchmarked factors. Free launch is updated. ADM flows through that. Enrollment, the basic aid per pupil that is the add-on piece, that's going to change biannually.

[06:07:40] um right now it is an optional um funding formula outside the soq but it is re-benchmarked and inevitably the you know cost goes up when it's suggested if it goes if it were to go into the soq as a mandated program um that you know there would be no uh immediate state physical impact it would just follow unless there was a formula change but it would be a mandatory um account in the sop for state funding and local participation would be mandatory ah thank you and and the local

[06:08:17] match of course and that's the critical piece okay but now we we have almost universal participation inevitably year in and year out maybe you know historically just a handful of divisions might not participate some years miss holton on that other comments on this dr northern i'm not going going to pretend to have any answers, but I'm just trying to get a balance here because we're

[06:08:51] all for flexibility, but we're also not just for like, maybe it'll work, maybe it won't. So I'd like us to try to strike a chord here with like some return on investment measure, some, you know, I don't know what, but it's got to be something where we ask them to maybe evaluate whether they used this money and it actually you know moved an outcome that they were interested in um i'm always interested in an earn your autonomy kind of model you know like you're doing great you know

[06:09:27] you you're doing really well by students so we're not going to you know ask a lot of you or you're not meeting the needs of your students very well and so we're going to give you all this flexibility with the money but you also need to show us that you've used it effectively and you've got something to show for it so however because i feel like flexibility is not just a no you know um it's it's also requires some accountability i'll use that word um on on the um on the other end to show that we've moved the needle on whatever goal we're trying to move the needle on mr rotherhand i had

[06:10:04] the same thought as dr northern like thinking about this like i mean it would seem to me if i were in the legislature it would be thinking about what sort of reciprocal obligations we attach to to this that we expect from school divisions, whether that's around, you know, parent engagement or other things, how you're going to use it. But I was leery. And so, I mean, I thought about some of these ideas, but I'm leery to be, do we want to do that? And this is, so this is a question for my colleagues. Do we want to be doing that from this dais, like writing that kind of policy, or do we want to trust them or put in the message that there should be appropriate measures attached to this? Because I agree that we don't want this, and this has been a problem with particularly some

[06:10:42] federal covid relief funds that have just been sort of you know money left on the stump um and we've gotten the the results we'd expect but i just wasn't like do we want to be up here crafting that didn't necessarily seem like our role so is there is there language you could put in encouraging them to make put in appropriate measures to drive effectiveness of this dollars that could be an evaluative component i think some of it's probably a program design component if i'm so i was thinking about the, sorry, the, when Dr. Northern brought up what kind of ROI can we examine or make a part

[06:11:19] of this? I mean, why not use things like school improvement plans to drive the flexibility? So if a school knows I've got to improve on X, Y, or Z, then that's where that flexible funding comes in and provides for a means by which we're getting some outcome-based measures, you know, that you're looking for there dr coons or or you could require them to tie the flexible funding plan to the roi in their sieve yeah

so that you're at least forcing the decision making you're giving them the flexible funds but they're using a planning tool that is already in existence you're

[06:11:57] not asking them to do additional but you're asking to them actually track the roi so you're signaling without and further driving some accountability some deeper accountability to school improvement plans. Ms. Olden? So some of this, what you all are looking, well, some of the answer, I think what you're looking for is in the accountability system, which we're looking at separately. But to the extent that we address it in funding prescriptions, the SOQs, we might want

[06:12:33] to look at the at-risk add-on fund, because the at-risk add-on fund, and Mr. Dickey will help me if I get this wrong, I'm sure, but it already requires divisions. Divisions have flexibility about how they use their at-risk add-on funds. However, they are required to use it on evidence-based programs. And I think there may even be a list that the division comes up with that they pick and choose from or with some possibility to go outside that list, but there is some process and uh if divisions are not meeting the current accountability metrics

[06:13:09] then there is i think a mechanism for for uh taking over um some of the allocation responsibility for those at-risk add-on funds but we have some capacity to have the office of school quality essentially tell them how to use their at-risk add-on dollars if they're not meeting metrics so sort of the approach dr northern is suggesting i think is already embedded in the at risk add-on fund pot which is it doesn't yet isn't yet in the soqs the main consequence that means that

[06:13:44] it's something the general assembly could you know fund or not fund on a year-by-year basis moving it into the soqs makes it more established dr siebert um maybe that's just moving us toward consensus on this one i do like uh i think it fits in even what secretary holton saying i think connecting this to the school improvement plans is good because the school print plans are impacted if you're in the office of school quality so i think putting language here about connecting your school improvement plan i like it for the language piece i just also like the fact that let's add some weight to the work that goes into school improvement planning you know that it gets

[06:14:21] connected to dollars i think that's exciting for the school working on their school improvement plan yeah dr northern so could i just add a ps that i'd love for it to be outcome based and not input based so using an evidence-based plan that you know it's hard right i mean we all think everything's evidence-based and it's hard like whose definition of evidence are you using so to the extent that we can tie that return on investment to outcomes versus inputs would be helpful i like that mr rotherham i don't disagree with any of this i'm saying something slightly

[06:14:59] different i i would like to see but again i don't think we want to design it i'd like to see more like if you're going to get this money what's going to be the obligation to communicate with parents what's going to be the obligation around being treated like but again i'm not sure that's that's what we want to do other than maybe not at that and that's something that they want to do over there if they decide to appropriate this this money but it just it seems like so i think we're talking two different things one's the roi and the evaluative and accountability piece which is very important and i'm supportive of the others is a basic program design piece um it seems strange that we keep putting money out without requiring people to make sure we're we're being transparent

[06:15:37] like yeah we're i think doing our level best here but we need partners so but again i'm not i'm not sure i'm comfortable doing that from up here other than signaling that like this money needs to be

aligned with with those sorts of goals i'd like to see them come up with something okay so are Are we clear on how we need to kind of slash this one a little bit?

[06:16:02] All right, so we need to go to four, and we'll take comments on this one. No comments on this one.

[06:16:25] Dr. Northern. Yeah, I just want to understand a little bit more what it is. It's saying that the IEP is going to be in a database that both the department and the people in the districts can see and work and respond on it together, right?

[06:16:43] So I'm thinking of it like it's a Google Doc and where everybody sees the same thing and they can go in and look at it anytime. Currently, right now, we have a statewide IEP system that is optional for school divisions to opt in and use and not opt in and use. So not only is it not transparent for families and for the public, it's not transparent across the state.

[06:17:06] So if the state department needs to do some of the prioritized monitoring that was recommended in the special education reports that we spoke about, we are unable to do that in a paper-based monitoring way because we can't see special education reports. So having a statewide system, one, allows for everybody to be required to use the same template and the same expectations for IEPs. Two, allows us to do paper-based monitoring as a level set when we're determining prioritized monitoring. And three, allows transparency at a

[06:17:42] level that is appropriate per FERPA. So, there are many states using a statewide IEP system. The other thing that is necessary in a statewide IEP system is weights. So, if you want to do a student-based weighted funding formula, and you want to be able to do weights based on what is in the IEP, a statewide system allows you to know that and transfer it to a funding system. So, this is still part of that number one, but it has all those other components of a standardized IEP system. And it's some of the things in the tone and the tenor you see in those reports around not

[06:18:20] having consistency, not setting consistent expectations, not knowing where professional development needs to go. It is because we don't have a system where we can see IEPs across the state. Excellent. Thank you very much. Makes sense. Dr. Siebert. My question on this one is actually related to another one that talks about student information systems I think for the commonwealth to provide tools and pay for the tools um would be a huge benefit to large numbers of divisions my my question on these and most of these prescriptions we have we don't have timelines on I just think that a a migration to a statewide IEP system like a migration to a statewide information

[06:18:59] system there there's going to be um apoplectic reactions in the field if if if it feels like this is happening next year or something so there's there's some and i know that none of these things that require lots of money in time in the comment it's not going to move that fast but i just i don't know how we get at some some timeline pieces there to maybe ease the nerves a little bit on this and the student information system happy to put that in other comments here are we

[06:19:32] ready to move to number five okay i'm it's on number five so miss hilton so i'm grateful to the department for the handouts i asked how many how many teachers the allocation is 10 million dollars and i'm not clear whether that's 10 million per year or 10 million over the biennium but it seems like a very small amount of money compared to the volume of need but the department

[06:20:07] says there are a lot of other funds to be drawn down so i mean i'm supportive of the concept certainly but i just wonder whether it's going to produce anything like the volume of new teachers that are required by our 4 000 short system dr kance miss holton the first 10 million will come out of esser dollars and are committed in esser dollars so the esser dollars are committed to the first 10 million outside of this prescription for this year and all of the numbers and all of the work we have partnered with the national grow your own center which is working with

[06:20:42] i will let katie answer how many states to advise us and think about all of the funding sources that are available when you move to an apprenticeship model it moves us just from department of education dollars to department of labor dollars and there's a significant um bolus of money that katie's team is working on with department of the virginia department of labor to think about how to braid those funds and i'll let katie answer any weedy questions but that's just the high level approach that we're taking in this space. Yeah, and so as Dr. Coons mentioned, we are partnering with the

[06:21:16] National Grow Your Own Center. They're partnering, they're working with over 29 states plus DC on this, and as you'll see in the cost calculations, through VDOI, we can get up to $7,500 potentially to be able to support additional work through Grow Your Own, and then there's also additional funds for students that qualify for Pell Grants as well as Perkins. So just so I understand, even with those, I mean, I hear you, you can draw down other funds, but this is basically going to contribute a few thousand dollars per student, per teacher to be grown, and it would

[06:21:56] be at a cost of $10 million per year. So the biennial, if we bring it into the SOQs, then it's a biennial calculation we're presenting to the General Assembly. So it should be at the $20 million dollar level not the 10 million correct thank you other questions or comments here dr northern yeah i'm just wondering three percent i mean i don't know where that came from and i guess so what my first question is why three percent i mean should we and second is it for all positions or is this i mean should we target it to you know math you know ela science or is this

[06:22:35] every type of teaching position that we're capturing here so just some clarifying questions on on those two points sure the vacancy rate around three percent is where we were prior to some of the stressors in the teacher shortage conversations we are currently with august data higher than four percent with recent data we're hoping to be at that threshold given the variance across the state and the data that we collected in august we have some school divisions 20 percent of our school divisions with zero to one vacancy. We have some school divisions that are much higher

[06:23:13] and the percentage is a wide, wide range. So we feel like three percent is that threshold where you're managing your personnel and above three percent, you need a tailored program to really start to think about that. I think the bias with defining which shortages is also a localized issue because if i go to some localized places they may need high school math teachers and chemistry teachers and we've heard this across the state i might go to another school division and they need first grade and kindergarten teachers so i would hate for us to prescribe a localized situation

[06:23:50] in the content area we want to push on because it is a localized and diverse staffing need across our state so it's three percent total no matter what type of teachers what you're saying yeah or how they report their vacant they report vacancies to us and they report a vacancy rate yep happy to clean that language up if it's unclear are there questions or comments here

[06:24:15] okay prescription six okay questions and comments here i'm lining it so timeline this one too okay that's northern can we have a um some language in there just trying to get at the connection to

[06:24:54] higher ed to employment learnings you know we want to track them beyond high school we want to track them post high school would be great the idea mr rotherham my understanding dr coons is that's exactly the work that you're doing and have been have been leading and so this yes we're just connecting a crumbling road to a super highway so it's about getting those to connect but we're happy

[06:25:26] to make that explicit if that's the will of the board. Anything else? Okay. And then we do have a final slide here on discussion. Is there anything else that we need to add here? Okay. I understand they're raring to go people here. I want to tell you that we noticed public comment to start between 3.30 and 4. So my request here is we need to be concise. So we may have some additional questions

[06:26:04] or we may have some people that don't agree that prescriptions need to be made here. However, I'm asking that everyone please keep it tight. Thank you. Okay, that being said, I'm starting on this end.

[06:26:24] Mr. Rotherham. I think we'll get to when we get around. I will yield my time. I will yield my time as well. Dr. Northern. I mean, all right. So I think on the prescriptions front, um, I think my biggest concern is that we just keep pushing forward, right? That we, um, if we're going to say, well, we're still gonna, we still want to do it some of the old way, that we also, um, agree that, um, it's, it's not efficient and that, um, it's not the way other states do it

[06:27:02] because it's not efficient. Um, and so that we, you know, whatever we end up with, it's just like, you know a necessary evil if that's what this board ends up agreeing to rather than this is um what we see is effective and best for for kids i yield my time okay y'all know that that's very dangerous right yielding your time down to this end of the they're following your advice yeah i suspect we have some of the same concerns okay um dr sievert lots of little things but just i think

[06:27:38] the big ones that kind of honors the previous conversations we've had and kudos to Dr. Koons and her team for putting out these additional documents we have here in our folder. I think there's an opportunity I think to kind of fit under one umbrella that to move the at-risk add-on into SOQ. I think you know most years all divisions use it and one year one division didn't. I still think that that that's decades long. It's there. I think moving that SOQ makes sense. The other piece that I think is hugely important and I think could be kind of borrowed a little bit of math from

[06:28:14] the JLARC study is that divisions, like in full disclosure, where our entire division is community eligibility provision, the data from free or reduced lunch now going 8, 10 years ago is just not good numbers going into that. So I think that the idea of at-risk add-on moving to SOQ, and you got this from all the organizations saying, looking at that math, using eight-year-old data to figure that out, there's a better way. I think the at-risk add-on SOQ, if there's

[06:28:51] desire, I think the class size reduction could go to SOQ as well. But then the other great handout we have here from Dr. Kuhn's team is about the Virginia Literacy Act, and I think that with all the general assembly has done for the virginia literacy act um all the work we've done the great reports we've had those things happening yes right now that money's kind of in that flexible funding pot for for the september budget but i think that you know we need to probably put in virginia literacy act in a more

definitive way and then then lastly you know a bony throw in the field that i think is much less expensive based on the september budget is recommending we get rid of

[06:29:28] support staff cap the sports app cap has been eroded by the past several budgets and another big bite was taken out of it in the september amendment so i think you know that that idea um of before we talk about prescribing new things and moving forward let's uh take a look at that that piece so those are the macro level ones i'd like to throw out there madam president thank you miss holton so i would endorse uh those three uh and particular with respect to the uh literacy act that we we should be getting the reading specialists funded that are necessary for the

[06:30:07] literacy act and as i understand it both from the materials we've been given and from the presentation apparently that the legislature the house appropriations committee got yesterday from um their staff uh that the fourth and fifth grade letter reading specialists are still not funded and i'm not completely clear on that and hope you all can help us clear that up but we absolutely need to fully fund the literacy act as a bare minimum um i want to speak to the average add-on but before that just kind of more globally i mean what the jlark study told us which the divisions really already knew is that the state and many of us already knew is the state was

[06:30:47] radically underfunding its share of public education so even you know if you take mr hanson's point that maybe we're spending enough all all told um and i would i would not agree with that but even assuming that that's the case the division of money between this the allocation of responsibility between the state and the localities is off base the state is not doing its share and hasn't been for a long long time and the consequence of that and that and they get away with it because the soqs are the basis of what they use to determine what the pot that

[06:31:26] has to be funded so they can essentially say we're funding 60 but we're funding 60 of the soqs that are nowhere near adequate to meet the needs and we know they're not adequate to meet the needs because virtually no divisions fund at only the soq level so and the consequence of that is that divisions that can afford to spend more than the soqs do and a lot of them spend a lot more. Almost all of them spend considerably more, and it means that property tax variation is

[06:32:01] determining way too big a percentage of the overall spending on public education in the Commonwealth. And it means that when we go visit schools in Petersburg, they look a lot different than when we go visit schools in Prince William or Loudoun or just the amount of technology, high-quality teachers, et cetera, et cetera.

[06:32:22] It's radically different across our divisions. And the SOQ, the underestimates of the SOQs is, I think, at the heart of a lot of that. So I think this is not a small problem. It's a big problem. And we should be looking at bold recommendations. I think removing the support cap is one.

[06:32:40] I think the enhanced at-risk add-on, bringing that into the SOQs would help. But only if we can amend the formula as recommended in JLARC to base it on a truer poverty measure. So I would recommend we bring the enhanced at-risk add-on into the SOQs, meaning that we're funding special ed kids, EL kids, and high poverty kids at a higher level.

[06:33:06] As we all know, the research shows that they need. And the way to do that would be by accepting the JLARC formula adjustments and bringing the at-risk add-on funds into the SOQs. Another item that's really similar to the support cap that is mentioned in the JLARP report and also in the

communications we have from the coalition, excuse me, of school organizations, which includes our local leaders,

[06:33:45] Our local superintendents, our school board association, our PTA, et cetera, principals association, et cetera, et cetera. Another important recommendation there that's highlighted in JLARC and that I think we should include is we should recommend that the General Assembly use the division average to calculate salary instead of the linear weighted average.

[06:34:07] And the short version of what we're doing now is basically, if you just, we basically, the SOQs say, this is how many people you need to run a school, and then this is how much the cost per person is. That's the salary calculation.

[06:34:24] Well, basically, they didn't like how the numbers were turning out, so they just lopped off the high ones. So it's not a real average. It's an average that's cheating. It was done when we had a need to cut the budget a little.

[06:34:40] And in the general assembly, we may need to cut the budget, but that's not up to us. The SOQs that we recommend should prescribe what it really takes to run the schools. And so I would recommend that we use the division average to calculate the costs instead of the linear weighted average as recommended in JLARC and as recommended by our partner organizations at the local level.

[06:35:03] And the, oh, I didn't hear Mr. Dr. Siebert, you mentioned in your email the counselor ratios. And we did hear from Dr. Raley that that was one thing the public raised was the counselors.

[06:35:22] And we have a prescription in 2021 to enhance the counselor ratio. Many divisions already do, those that can afford to do, but they're doing it on their own dime without the state's help. Um, and so I recommend that we, um, uh, include the, the counselor, uh, ratio recommendation of one to two 50. That's it. There's others I could go on about, but I'll say it's nice. I'll stop

[06:35:53] menu. Not menu. Okay. Um, so we have given plenty of, uh, feedback, I believe to the department. Dr. Coons, how do you feel? I don't feel good. Okay. I need, I need to know from the board, if you want us to move on a at-risk add-on a VLA act a support staff a counselor ratio like I need we've had individuals yeah I need to know they went back no I think we should just take the one by one madam president because I think okay like I'll speak on the at-risk I completely agree I'd like it to have a little bit of language that as we transition to a weighted student formula I don't

[06:36:32] want this to be seen as a forever you know this will become ideally will become unnecessary as we transition to a, to a better financing system. And so I'd be, if my colleagues are like a little language that this is not a, into perpetuity, but in the, in the interim, this is an important funding stream and I can certainly support that one. Can I ask a clarifying question? Can I just, what's, so thank you. Well, can you clarify the process? We went through the recommendation, Halton just gave, Dr. Siebert just gave a whole list of some additional ones.

[06:37:10] And then, but this, our next steps is to finalize this, get clarity to staff, and then to vote on that. And we're trying to do that today. No, so we will finalize in concept all of these topics that we want to move on.

[06:37:30] okay um and then in december we will vote on a final draft okay and so right now what we need to figure out is what do we want to do in addition to the ones that we reviewed here and so um all that

being said we have had um the at-risk add-on as an opportunity we have had um um adding the reading specialists. And side note on that is my concern is that the Virginia Literacy Act puts a

[06:38:08] heavy emphasis on all teachers, not just reading specialists, getting this kind of training. And what concerns me is if we do not put an emphasis on all teachers getting specialized training in the science of reading and we simply focus our efforts or our dollars, our resources on reading specialists only, we are going to have a small chip away at a larger problem. And so if we equip every teacher with those skills that they need, that is an across the board all day long

[06:38:47] opportunity rather than a okay joey you're going to miss so-and-so for 30 minutes just to respond on that last point it's my understanding that the literacy act encompasses having reading specialists being the people who are educating the general ed teachers so they are not just interventionists but if you want the general ed teachers to know the science of reading you've got to have a reading specialist because that's who's doing the professional development well that's who's doing the professional development right now well i thought that the i thought the bla contemplated

[06:39:26] enhanced reading specialist positions so as to partly to help make that professional development for the general ed teachers happen the virginia literacy act requires a certain number of professional development hours for all reading teachers and then the reading specialists are there to support the implementation of science of reading not solely to deliver professional development but to implement to support the implementation okay so we have um in addition

[06:39:59] to the at-risk add-on in addition to this request on vla we have what two more from you dr sievert well i'm just rather than saying by just going let's go one at a time well that's what i want to be able to do that so i think we want to up or down do we add yes no so here's your opportunity do we add what's your issue number one um the at-risk add-on to the soq and updating the formula for community eligibility provision okay so that being said the way that we are going to do this if you all feel like you are um sufficiently informed on this which you don't do you want

[06:40:39] okay dr northern so my clarifying question is right now is at-risk identified through frl only the free and reduced lunch. Is that how at-risk kids are identified right now? I defer to 10 largely. Yes, that's correct. Okay. And what percentage, do you happen to know, what percentage of, do we have FRL percentages by district anywhere to anywhere? And it's free lunch only, not reduced technically, the metric. Okay. It's free only. Is that data available on

[06:41:13] the website under School Quality Profile or elsewhere? We just use that data to, or the legislature use that data to appropriate the flexible funding. They use that free lunch formula. My larger point is it's been discredited over and over again. It's just a poor measure.

[06:41:35] I would prefer a certification measure. Do we not have that in Virginia? Do we not certify based on receipt of federal benefits is that why you're asking for a cep measure i think that may be what the jlark jlark has a recommendation of a better poverty measure and discusses it at some length and i think we should go with the jlark recommend language on that unless perhaps mr dickey can help us clarify it but is the cep what you're suggesting instead of frl defer to kent i just know that for as a cep division i always speak of 100 divisions our burgers lunch data that's used in these

[06:42:12] calculations is many many years old yes because we don't collect forms um from families so the way that it's done in places that can do it is it's certified so in other words if you're getting you know it's

federally certified so if you're getting receipt of snap benefits or you know other types of benefits that's the way that you're identified because frankly so many kids can qualify for frl who don't who don't need it you know because it it tends to get watered down it tends to well here we go same problem it doesn't get targeted to the kids who

[06:42:48] need it the most so um the the more that we can better uh devise a measure to identify kids who are at risk i'm concerned that if at risk is frl that it's going to be another water down but dr canes we're happy in the drafting to give you a couple different options of what you would consider at risk whether it's academic whether it's direct certified free and then you could vote through a couple of different options what would be helpful to us is do you want us to move forward with the at-risk add-on and then we're happy to give you a couple different options as we write that so that you guys can narrow down where you want to go even if we do that through the same

[06:43:28] way you gave us feedback over the past several weeks you are saying you you have access direct certified like i will have to research and then i don't know it all depends on that number six and that statewide information system whether or not we have the capacity to do direct cert but i'm happy to research that and get back to the board if that's the will of the board miss holton may i ask that one of the options you bring us be the one that jlark is recommending recommended in in their July 23 report. Okay. So in trying to pull this together to a logical conclusion here,

[06:44:03] if you had one choice of what you wanted to add to these prescriptions, Ms. Holton, which would it be? I'm not willing to do that. I'm sorry. I have a number that I would say that I think need to be added, and that is absolutely one of them. What is? Enhanced at-risk data. Okay.

[06:44:21] i'm not limit willing to i'm not prepared to limit my advice to that one okay mr dr siebert okay i do we get the consensus on that one yes okay um i'm not sure where we are in virginia are we okay with the at-risk add-on to have them bring it back for some more information i have can we go through the whole list and just because i think we're not going to be able to say yes or no without having the whole list and that's the problem because we don't have a comprehensive

[06:44:54] list i think we can give okay i can give a list of our we have a working okay right i mean alan's is the enhanced at risk add-on he said reading specialist slash vla and then he said the support staff cap yeah alan did i quote you correctly so that's three and then i added to that the division weighted average oh and the counselor ratios so that's five one two three that's what i have to okay so that is only five talk about lots more beyond that but

[06:45:37] okay so that would be seven i don't know if you've got you've got one two no no i'm adding two what's up here that would be right and frankly the number of the ones that are already up there are either zero cost or cost nominal so this these are the maybe the ones that we've proposed are much are in a different order of magnitude from the ones that are already okay on the list so here's the question do we want to bring the whole list back this list as part of

[06:46:10] these opportunities or do we want to whittle them down right now madam president just a side note um have we allocated the time from 15 30 to 16 hundred full public input and can we pause and do the public input and then continue that would be up yeah we can do that that's the idea the will of the board um all right let's take our pause here and we will shift to that if you give me just one

[06:46:46] minute um good afternoon as stated in the board's bylaws it's the pleasure of the board to accept

[06:54:49] public comment on all matters related to public education in Virginia we ask that you please provide your name and affiliation at the beginning of your remarks speakers shall limit their comments to three minutes or we are getting it put up right now but you will see um that there will be a timer on the screen and the timer will be ah here it is green three minutes at one minute the screen will turn yellow the screen will turn red when your time is up at that point please close

[06:55:24] your remarks promptly speakers may provide copies of their comments or any other items for the board to mr joe crook sitting right there mr crook will then hand out those items to the board members for you so all written comments received during the public comment will be collected and provided to the board as soon as possible after public comment uh well actually just said we're going to pass it out you may also email a copy of your remarks to mr jim chapman director of board

[06:56:00] relations and so with that um i will begin with the sign up list daniela is the only name i have daniela and then a christina nonnelly is daniela here christina nonnelly how about kathy drago

[06:56:23] shirlin jenkins aaron reed david rudman thank you for looking at this um my half the time will

[06:57:05] be spent asking you to just look through what i've been given to you um eight years ago this board denied my k-12 latin certification because i'd had a firing in the past um after that time i spent eight years feverishly building the biggest bestest latin curriculum i could build and first i put it in paper and then i put it online and your three minutes hasn't started

[06:57:28] David Rudman: Okay, so hi my name is David Rudman and, uh, eight years ago this board denied my k12 Latin certification application because I had a firing before that um, after that time I spent the next eight years feverishly working building the biggest best is what I thought what I would have liked to do.

[06:57:57] time. I spent the next eight years feverishly working, building the biggest, bestest, what I thought what I would have liked to have taught with during my first burnout year. And this is it. I just wanted you to see it today. Next month, I'll talk about me. But today, I just want to talk to you about my curriculum. That's all. So this is, I put it first into paper format so I could teach with it. And then I put it on to online. So it's online at writelatin.org.

[06:58:28] And it works with this textbook that you see this is the universally acknowledged best Latin textbook you all don't use it. Nearly every public school uses the Cambridge course instead, which is a Britcom spend a whole year learning about Britain, and it's all comedy.

[06:58:46] This is more classical schools private schools use it and foreign countries use it, because if you flip through it, you'll see there is not an English word in it. immersion um so students learn a new word from the margin and then are referred back to the margin from the index if they forget it to go the problem with that and the problem with latin in general is that it is all passive it's all comprehensible input and that's unique because

[06:59:19] every other foreign language insists on the importance of active output and latin seems to be special that they we think we don't need it well i think we do as a latin teacher and we can't speak it because nobody can speak it i'm a part of salvi we do our best to speak it we're not that good at it we can't

just pull it out so the next lesson was writing and so i made my machine online to automatically check blue correct through orange utterly incorrect whether student correctly wrote

[06:59:54] the word um the latin word so i'm getting students just all the time to produce latin this is a new kind of concept nobody's ever done it before in latin so i'm asking i i want you to just flip through me your first five pages and the last five pages um the interior stuff's not so important it's just to fulfill standards oh am i out of time oh thank you okay so um yeah so just i'll go silent now and I hope you look through that. Please give me the books back, like take the packets for yourself.

[07:00:55] Jason Schiller, followed by Samantha Schiller.

[07:01:08] Hello, my name is Jason Schiller, and I'm a parent of two kids with PANDAS. PANDAS, Pediatric Acute Onset Neuropsychiatric Syndrome, and PANDAS, Pediatric Autoimmune Neuropsychiatric Disorder Associated with Streptococcal Infections, are neuroimmune disorders where an immune system activation, and the associated brain inflammation cause a misdirected immune response resulting in the onset or worsening of neurological, psychological, emotional, and cognitive symptoms.

[07:01:39] How can the school board help with this? Well, greater awareness of PANS and PANDAS would be of great benefit to students and families who struggle with this condition, and it would provide support for social and academic well-being of the school community in general. Early recognition of possible cases of PANS and PANDAS, a referral for aggressive antibiotic and anti-inflammatory treatment can return a child to a normal baseline and reduce future flares of neurological, psychological, and emotional symptoms, which can be disruptive both to the child's learning, emotional well-being, and also the social health of the classroom. Additionally, greater awareness of PANS and PANDAS

[07:02:16] will also provide a necessary context for support for other health impairments regarding 504s and IEPs, tools for dealing with symptoms, discipline, detecting increases in flare behaviors, vigilance and preventing the spread of infection, and increased communication regarding uptick in symptoms and sickness in the classrooms. So today I'm here to ask you for in-service training for school nurses across Virginia. School nurses are the first line of defense within the schools when a child begins to struggle with symptoms that are hard to recognize. It's critical for school nurses to be able to recognize PANS-PANDAS in order to support the emotional and educational development

[07:02:52] and advanced academic success. Without this support, neither individual students with PANS Pandas nor their school communities can develop to their full potential. It is this type of an awareness that has directly led to development and support strategies that not only allowed my daughter to stay in school, but to thrive in AAP version 4. There are two leading Pandas Advocacies, Aspire and Pandas Network, and they both have professionally developed in-service trainings available for school nurses and staff these are donor funded and have been provided to many schools free of cost i have a printout which i've distributed that talks a little bit about the

[07:03:29] symptoms of pandas and also about the in-service trainings that are available thank you very much for your time samantha schiller followed by your terry hi my name is samantha schiller i'm 14 years old i'm a student and i've struggled with pandas for the last seven years pandas are short for pediatric autoimmune neuropsychiatric disorders associated with streptococcal infections.

[07:04:03] Usually, I say that I'm allergic to sickness or sick people, but that's still confusing. A PANS or PANDAS flare is when an immune response causes a sudden increase in neurological, psychological, and

emotional symptoms. This isn't new. Doctors have known about it for over a hundred years that strep and other infections can trigger OCD, tics, and tremors. I had my first big PANDAS flare in February of 2017. It took eight months for me to be diagnosed. I was lucky to be diagnosed so quickly many kids go undiagnosed or misdiagnosed for years my pediatrician thought i developed autism overnight i was referred to a psychiatrist who happened to know a lot about pandas he mentioned it to my parents who asked my school counselor about it she put us in touch with

[07:04:39] another family at school whose kid had been diagnosed with pandas that family shared their experience and told us about dr latimer in dc that's how it goes for a lot of pandas families word of mouth and mom's networking i don't have bad flares often anymore but i flared for half of second grade and all of third. It made going to school very difficult and sometimes impossible.

[07:04:57] My feelings were so big and out of control that it was hard to focus. I would run out of the classroom if I was upset. I needed to have my favorite blanket with me all day. Most of my teachers did what they could to help. They tried to give me breaks and would let me read when I was overwhelmed. That helped, but there were people who worsened the situation too. The school psychologist insisted that I didn't need any accommodations and he said that my parents were being too easy on me and that I would grow out of it. For me, a flare then consisted of screaming, crying throwing things breaking things and causing harm to myself and those who tried to help me i experienced severe anxiety and ocd in my case ocd was mostly about the way things felt i couldn't leave the house until the ties or velcros on my shoes were exactly the same tightness

[07:05:35] i frequently changed my clothes i refused most foods things like that it was really hard for me to think rationally during a flare sometimes i thought my parents were trying to hurt me and would try to run away from them i held a lot of guilt over a long time for things i did that i i couldn't fully control once i got my tonsils out on the right antibiotics i went into remission i happily went to school made friends and did extracurricular activities this spring i developed lessons and taught 140 girls about veterinary science for my girl scout silver award this summer i spent 10 days away from home camping at the boy scout national jamboree i earned a presidential service award for 134 hours of community service in the past year i'm a freshman in high school i take honors in ap classes and pandas doesn't rule my life anymore i'm lucky to

[07:06:14] have a whole team of people like my doctors therapists and parents who support me and who helped me work through the hardest parts of my life as well as very kind and forgiving teachers friends and peers a lot of kids are not so lucky but you can help them if more teachers school counselors and psychologists knew about pans and pandas more kids would get the help and understanding that they need thank you eric terry followed by colleen eddie evie good afternoon president uh madam president and uh superintendent coons uh my name is eric terry i am the president of the Virginia Restaurant, Lodging, and Travel Association. We represent restaurants and hotels

[07:06:53] throughout the state. We're also affiliated with the National Restaurant Association and the American Hotel and Lodging Association, so we do represent both of those. I'm here really to talk about item H and really the programmatic accreditation and the challenges that have been occurring with the ACF accreditation that's occurring at many of our schools. I literally, my staff and I get a call probably every single day from a school who's struggling with the cost and the requirements some of those requirements would require all of our culinary schools we have 73 pro start schools which is a program that the national restaurant association has developed

[07:07:28] across the state we have 73 of those and literally under the acf requirements we would probably lose almost half of those schools to the requirement to have a full culinary kitchen which can cost literally millions of dollars as well as the accreditation which may be upwards of you know five figures or greater just to go through the accreditation process for the schools and the the struggles that are smaller schools and it's not just our smaller schools our schools in fairfax county are encountering it or you know halifax county i was in the other day and they're encountering the same challenge of being able to meet this requirement for the acf accreditation we are not opposed to accreditation in general the national restaurant association has programs

[07:08:08] for our pro start schools and there are other programs out there we just think that this this particular one is particularly egregious to you know our schools being able to qualify for it i think you know we are doing a number of programs we do training at the vatfax conference for our cte schools during the summer we also have teacher symposiums so we had one last week we do student boot camps and a number of other training programs that we all offer as our organization that are supported by the national restaurant association so we do believe that you

[07:08:39] You know, really either putting a pause on these or really looking at what that requirement is, is incredibly important to the schools and their ability to want to afford and meet the requirements. And, you know, I would just offer a quick note. One of our for-profit culinary schools down in Norfolk, which is formerly the Johnson & Wales School, they actually didn't receive their accreditation.

[07:09:00] And they are, you know, phenomenal culinary campus. And they said to me the other day, because they didn't have enough burners in the stove, that they didn't meet the accreditation. And so I think the criteria has just kind of gotten a little out of whack as to what our schools are trying to do. We have probably more than 5,000 students in our culinary programs throughout the state.

[07:09:18] I think, again, we have 73 ProStart schools, but probably another total of 126 culinary schools in our high schools. So please consider that when you look at that item. Thank you. Colleen Eddy. Colleen Beattie. Sorry.

[07:09:39] Good evening, Superintendent Coons and members of the board. My name is Colleen Eddy. I am the Director of Curriculum and Instruction for Fairfax County Public Schools. And I wanted to come and speak with you tonight about the recommendation of instructional materials related to the Virginia Literacy Act.

[07:09:59] Fairfax County Public Schools is deeply committed to ensuring that all students receive evidence-based, high quality, culturally responsive instruction and reading that aligns to science-based reading research. Thank you for the leadership that you have shown toward those same ends.

[07:10:15] We are undertaking an adoption of a new comprehensive core instructional materials as described in the Literacy Act, and we've been watching closely the Commonwealth's review process to ensure that we can implement a new curriculum in the coming school year. This will be a Herculean effort for our teachers and staff and a substantial investment for our school division.

[07:10:38] We want to make sure that the resources we adopt are absolutely best in class and will meet the needs of our diverse student population. To meet the ask of the Literacy Act, we've been doing our due diligence to review the materials that were submitted for review in each cycle, in parallel to the work of

the Virginia Literacy Partners, so that we'd be ready to conduct that basal resource review locally and proceed immediately following the board's vote in December.

[07:11:05] In reviewing the resources recommended for approval as posted on today's agenda, we're deeply concerned that resources were eliminated from the list of recommended comprehensive core instructional programs without yet clear justification. For example, the pairings of wit and wisdom with really great reading or foundations are no longer presented as recommended programs, despite being highly recommended by ed reports, the Knowledge Matters campaign, and several other state boards of education with similar legislation requiring evidence-based literacy instruction.

[07:11:42] We ask for transparency in decision-making and assurance that criteria aligned to evidence-based literacy instruction and science-based reading research drove the decision-making in the review process. Per the current process, our understanding is that the same initial review team also reviewed the appeal documents submitted by the vendors.

[07:12:04] We ask that the Board of Education review the justification for the elimination of any resources, in collaboration with an objective committee of experts, other than the original review team, to calibrate results before the final vote in December. In Fairfax, we have an imperative to meet our students' needs by engaging them with meaningful and diverse texts.

[07:12:27] Students deserve instruction that's both aligned to the science-based reading research and culturally relevant, as we seek to ensure that students become proficient readers, close achievement and opportunity gaps, and meet the expectations of the Virginia Literacy Act. Thank you.

[07:12:45] Okay. I don't think there's anybody else in. Madam Chair, I had Mr. Chapman go down and check and there is no one else downstairs. And I forwarded an email from Ms. Lucas. She has asked to remove her name from public comment. So we did double check and make sure no one is downstairs.

[07:13:05] I think everyone who's in the room currently has spoken or unless there's somebody who's not. OK, I figured they were. But all right. So we will close public comment then.

[07:13:22] OK. All right. So we are going to go back to our SOQ discussion. Are you ready? Because now I have this piped up. So I would like to go through these one by one here.

[07:13:41] I would like for us to vote on whether or not we want to have these included for the department to provide a prescription for, and we can give them specifics on that once we have those votes taken care of.

[07:13:59] Does anyone have anything that you want to say before we move on this item? Mr. Rotherham. Yeah. Clarifying question. Are we voting on including it or just getting analysis about it? including it because we don't we don't have the time to between now and then the december meeting to get a whole lot of analysis well but just to clarify nothing's final essentially we're accepting this on first review today then giving the department guidance with expectation of making final decisions so we may say we want more information on something because we think we want to include it and then may change our mind once we get that information right perhaps but we

[07:14:39] cannot overwhelm the department with you know incredible amounts of research that has to be done between now and december i will say the good news is most of these are ones that are either already well researched in the jlark report or prior prior prescriptions so there we do have evidence on

most of them already miss ashton can i make a motion please yeah so i think and again help me out here team i think there is i would like to make a motion because i think there's consensus specifically on directing staff to come back to us on the at-risk edition with some

[07:15:16] additional options including the jlark recommendation that was one that where there was clear consensus the the other items that were discussed were specifically around reading specialist support staff counselors and take into consideration the division average uh and my my motion would be to um include those but under the flexible spending that uh i instead of going one by one i think that what i saw in terms of the feedback is that schools superintendents need

[07:15:55] the flexibility to be able to find the appropriate staff to meet the needs of their students and if we're too prescriptive that we would tie their hands so that would be the motion that i in addition to the um prescriptions that were presented by the staff madam president mr stardifan can you read the motion one more time sure okay all right so my motion is to uh have a staff come back we to we agree that they're around the at risk what's it called add-on add-on address add-on that's what

[07:16:33] it says right here um we agree that the adverse add-on that staff will come back to us with some specific options to consider including the specific jlark recommendation around the at-risk add-on and that we as already has been presented around the flexible spending as a priority that we emphasize that the reading specialists support staff counselors and division division average

[07:17:04] prescription be allowed under flexible spending that is the motion i will second that motion discussion i would welcome the motion i would welcome the motion and support it with the clarification that the language will say the funding amount should be set based on those items necessary and then that the divisions could have flexibility in terms of how they're going to

[07:17:39] allocate it so for instance the funding amount would need to be sufficient to have one counselor for 250 students and would be sufficient to have the reading specialists for fourth and fifth grade required by VLA and would be sufficient to cover the difference between the division average prevailing cost versus linear weighted average cost and would be sufficient to cover the elimination of the support cap in other words the SOQs is really all about setting funding minimums and then i'm hearing the board wisely i think wants to say divisions once we've

[07:18:17] set those minimums that determines how much the state must invest and how much the localities must invest but then the localities would have flexibility to move money around between the pots am i understanding that is that where you're heading um that seems like a different motion i think that's a different because we have a motion in the second i guess now it's time for discussion um if the motion is not going to be amended i think we should move forward with the vote okay any other discussion before we move forward well then i would if that's not the motion

[07:18:53] then i would raise the concern that it's not meeting the needs of the students of the commonwealth based on those elements okay the board operates on motions and we have one on the floor does anyone else have a comment as part of this discussion before we vote well i'll raise a substitute motion that that we would include inflexible funding uh sufficient funding to cover those four elements as previously outlined so that will be done after this vote no she needs

[07:19:28] a second for the substitute motion and just upon clarification when you say inflexible funding i think you mean in the flexible funding in the pot of flexible funding that there be sufficient but there be

specification of standards on each of those four but that we're talking about the the flexible funding pot that's dedicated towards learning loss and and pandemic is that the is that the pot we're talking about yes okay yeah i think and i just want to ask because we're going to have to write this mche is adding counseling into that flexible funding pot i think that okay you know

[07:20:06] what i think i'm going to withdraw my substitute motion and i'll just make my motions separately after your motion gets voted on how about that we'll make me cleaner okay anything else and your motion possession includes the at-risk add-on right we'll dr siebert so i understand why answering motion is it moves the idea of support funding recommendations into that um so we're not specifically taking a position yet on whether or not we recommend eliminating support staff cat

[07:20:41] so that would be different that would be different okay thank you okay are we ready to take a vote on that okay miss holton or do you do you have a question yeah my question is if there's any return on investment i mean we've been talking about all that and i'm just a little confused on i think that's that's certainly part of what we've discussed here yeah i would accept an amendment

[07:21:15] to include specific language around return on investment or some accountability is that yes i i agree president i have a question on that dr siebert yeah i thought every term investment conversation moved toward endorsing the school improvement planning process is that different or same right you wanted to put that under that right but so they're aligned right i i'm also looking at dr coons yes my understanding was in this the student the school improvement plans

[07:21:55] have outcome-based components to them so they measure and do their improvement plans based on smart goals and outcomes and things like that so it's using that planning process that already exists to track whether or not they're making impact on their outcome goals so i think that's what ellen is asking for that was my understanding prior apologies everybody clear okay miss halton voting on this on dr ms ashton's motion yes i keep trying to give it to you i know it's good

[07:22:30] i dr sievert hi miss ashton hi dr north yes i made the motion yeah dr northern i mr sturdifant mr rotherham mr hanson i mean and chair votes i okay so that's how we incorporate that and um before we move to anything else is there anything else on this particular piece um dr sievert was

[07:23:05] their interest in in taking a position on support staff cap it's pretty universally hated i just the numbers gets much smaller i i didn't i was i thought we had census on that earlier if we don't then we'll leave it for now and i would say we don't know actually how much the outstanding cost of it is because we haven't yet done the calculation including what the general assembly did this fall but it's down to less but i i would i i will i will move that we direct the department to come back to us with a recommendation around removing the support staff cap i mean i just need

[07:23:44] to educate before we and it we need to have a potential second on that motion second and my question will be if that's going to be too much for burden on staff but yes okay so now discussion dr norther yeah i just i wanted to understand more clearly the history of the cap and the repercussions of removing that cap so maybe that's a question for you dr sievert is mr dickey still here no mr that's what i was trying to find out mr dickey is still on a contract negotiation call that was scheduled at four o'clock so he will not be back till 4 30 but we can have him come

[07:24:23] back up at 4 30. he said he'd promised he would be here at 4 30. i can try to give a layman mr madam sheriff my president layman's explanation go ahead 2008 great recession had to balance the budget

took lots of tricks and tools and everything vrs changes whole bunch of stuff one of the changes was a cap on support staff and and really at that point in time it was that you have one support staff member per 4.1 teacher again i'm making up numbers to illustrate something here um and really truly you know the chuckle at the time was the fact that the number was like a 4.12

[07:25:00] was kind of like somebody kept typing into the spreadsheet until it equaled the number and again it it served a purpose but it was intended to be short term well here we are you know 12 14 years past the the the recession and over time every year the vpec groups the coalition of all professional organizations are saying this is arbitrary it was put in as a short-term thing it's still there can we please take it off because it under counts instructional assistance and everything else so over the last several years the general assembly has chipped away at it they've moved it they've changed the number improved the ratio and they pulled out certain

[07:25:36] positions from it so that they don't count and more of that happened in the september budget how much and how great i don't know because the september budget is still pretty new but um the number is it was already getting pretty small and it's definitely smaller now and and it is it's just an arbitrary holdover of the recession and and it really artificially inflates now the deficit for school divisions has gotten smaller it used to be a bigger number and the problem with that bigger number year after year for year accumulated huge amounts of dollars that didn't go so um the number now is smaller that's good it would be nice just to get rid of

[07:26:15] this vestige of the great recession and the impact of that if i may just add on is it means that local divisions are paying for positions like bus drivers and cafeteria workers and office workers and instructional aides entirely out of local dollars because the state's not paying its share of those extra positions at all because of the support cap the ones that are over the cap mr rotherham could someone give us the steel man version of what a smart opponent would say about

[07:26:48] why we wouldn't want to do this like what's the what's the like strong serious argument against this dr siebert historically there was sympathy in the general assembly for instructional assistance in some of those positions um one of the categories of positions that you know sometimes people got hung up on was that it also limited assistant principal positions and there was a pushback oh we don't need more administrators but what we've heard through the past several years of teacher you know recruitment retention is that teachers want support they want somebody who can help them with the unruly child and give them feedback on their instruction and assistant

[07:27:24] principals help do that so again it was it became almost like uh again this is just in committee meetings the general assembly etc well i'm okay with these positions coming out but i don't think they need those the the really the support staff cap which is a cap on a whole set of positions they've now reduced the number mr sturdivant madam president this question goes to dr coombs dr coombs can you weigh in on it dr canes not well um this is not an area i have dug in significantly i can agree with um dr siebert that this is a point of contention with school divisions

[07:28:02] i don't know what the new cost is based on the budget conversation that dr siebert said about eliminating the sport cap i don't know what that does to the budget and what that does to the re-benchmarking and what that does to all those formulas but kent dickey does in six minutes so if there's something you want to do and pause I think I'm happy to to just generalize but this is not my area of expertise I would much rather have Kent speak to it I don't know if you want to take a pause and vote on

item H or is this our last item on SOQ before then no you have division weighted average okay so then let's just take a pause here and go through the division weighted

[07:28:41] average issue and then hopefully Kent will be back by that time oh I'm gonna go find Kent okay and then we have we have three more i think the division weighted average the counselors and the reading specialist we put those in her motion well i didn't know the division well i i would like to make motions on all three of those so just for clarity and and i think division weight average would be accounting too a little bit yeah that's true division weight i can't possibly talk about that but but i can make my motion on counselors

[07:29:19] okay go right ahead how about i do counselors and reading specialists together i would make a motion that we add a prescription to the standards of quality uh mandating counselors at a ratio of one to 250 and that we add to the soqs a mandate for reading specialists to the full extent required by

[07:29:43] the virginia literacy act i'll second for the sake of discussion discussion madam president i think the counselor ratios were in the 2021 and maybe even our 2019 prescriptions again that predates me so i think there's math on that so i think it would be a question about for the board to to look at those numbers um and the math may have already been adjusted because the general assembly did lower the counseling ratios over the past couple uh sessions um and and earlier we had a

[07:30:20] pretty good conversation madam president you weighed in on the part of the rough reading specialists and and the teachers as a whole and i i just really and what i see happening in the field right now i i i'm limited to one division is this an end i i do see that these reading specialists are the ones who are coming alongside the teachers and making sense of this um and so uh i i and again i i think whether we prescribe it or the general assembly does gerson was requiring it and therefore i think anything they require they should pay their share

[07:30:52] for other comments um madam president by the general assembly if they prescribe it they would have to pay for it right miss holton your recommendation who will cover the cost of it so my recommendation is that we prescribe it meaning that we send it to the general assembly for their consideration and then if they accept our prescription they have to pay for it and if they don't accept our prescription then it goes away i mean we don't have any we don't have any

[07:31:27] power of the purse here when it goes down to local school divisions will the general assembly cover the complete costs or with that then the school divisions will have to be mandated that's correct you're correct but if it goes into the soqs if our prescription that it go into the soqs is accepted by this body then the general assembly would decide whether to accept that or not and if they do then they fund their share of it and the localities have to fund their share of it so it could be an increased funding at the local level except that the reality is the localities are

[07:32:04] already almost all of them overfunding all of these positions so i think you would find the localities uniformly supporting this because it means they're already spending the money at the local level and it just means they get more state match for it and i think you would see that that's reflected i i'll have to check but i think that they are supportive of the reading specials positions i think it's been in the statements that have been provided to us from the local organizations but i'll check those local organizations but not all local school divisions excuse me? That's local organizations, but not all local school divisions. It's the statewide

[07:32:40] associations of the local, but you're right, there might be dissenters within those memberships. And some local school divisions have more of an ability to pay than others. So this could actually be a burden on lesser school divisions that don't have the funding to cover. Well, maybe one way to think about it is that we should, I'm not sure, I can't tell whether it's in the DPEC letter or not, but one way to think about it is that if we put it forward for consideration at our meeting next month, then we can hear from the public and the associations and get their feedback on it before we decide what to do in December. But you're saying move forward

[07:33:15] before we hear public input on it. Well, what I'm hearing today, we're just telling the department what we want them to bring back to us next month, and then we will vote next month on the document. Okay. Based on that, being in rural counties, I can't support it. Dr. Siebert, anything else i know you have your hand i i was just i think i was understanding the surface questions and and yes it would come down to whether the local division was already funding

[07:33:49] those positions like in sports afcap that largely is true uh counselors at one to 250 maybe not and this is where you know i i got a little bit of concern about you know the motion concluding both virginia literacy and school counselors because i think they're a little bit different in that if we change the ratio for school counselors then yes then then that could have an impact whereas we're already the virginia is already requiring virginia literacy act and so that's i i kind of saw those two again i'm all for counselors but i i think they're they're two pieces i'd be happy to amend my motion to separate them if that would help they're together now

[07:34:25] miss ashton i'm uh in support of this and it's philosophical and it's also like aspirational i think that we've talked a lot about where we want to go in terms of way student funding formula and autonomy and by saying we're prescribing we're actually going the other direction and what i believe we all need is every teacher to be a counselor and every teacher to be a reading specialist and that is the way we're actually going to close the gap not by saying we have

[07:35:01] reading specialists we have counselors in addressing this so that's my like philosophical just that is the direction we need to go and schools and school divisions need the autonomy to find and identify the people and by prescribing it and it feels like what we're saying is that prescription with potentially unfunded unfunded mandate i think is sending the wrong message other comments before we vote okay this motion is mandating school counselors at a ratio of

[07:35:36] one to 250 and reading specialists at the requirements set out in the vla miss holton aye dr siebert hi mr hansen no miss ashton no dr northern no mr rotherham no mr sturdifan

[07:35:59] nay and chair votes nay okay i did yeah um okay now we're gonna pivot back to um discussion of the we had question on the support cap and then um the division weighted average so would you like to translate yes mr dickey i pivoted and asked them to ask you this question because with the budget changes that happened in september what is the leftover impact of the support staff

[07:36:39] cap yeah they they general assembly you know everything's on a per thousand metric you know the funded support positions they can they those can be you know send everything from central office administrators to attendance and health a variety of you know traditional you know non-classroom support staff and so the funding action in in uh september budget was moving that from 21 positions per thousand to 24 and so to that did not eliminate the full support cap the to do that which would

[07:37:15] be a significant cost um it would require uh about approximately a little over 26 per thousand to totally eliminate the the metric that's been capping the possessions well mr dickey do you have an estimate of the cost impact there you said a significant increase it's over well over 100 million and i'll and i'll get that thank you that's sufficient money that is real money okay but just to be i'm sorry miss holton so just to be clear it's our job to prescribe the minimum

[07:37:53] standards and then the general assembly decides what to fund i mean we we don't have to balance we're not supposed to balance out should we be spending more money on support staff versus more money on you know mental health needs that's the general assembly's job i think i think we're clear on the fact that it's the general assembly's job but i also to some degree want to provide some realistic wins that come out of this board um and at a hundred million dollars that's a little hard to see well if it's worth it i mean jlark recommendation is that this state should be

[07:38:28] funding at really a minimum of billion dollars extra in k-12 per year so we're that that was the whole point of the jlark report is that we're significantly underfunding k-12 education particularly the state chair dr northern so i think it matters what we mean well i mean support staff are many different categories right and support staff um honestly the research on them is is pretty thin um i believe and i totally get that um i i worked in a pretty tough school system

[07:39:03] at one point and and you want more people in your building you do um but you also want the people that are actually driving towards you know outcomes and i feel like you know if we want to talk about um support staff we need to talk about what type of support staff we really support and the ones that actually do have more of a research base behind them in terms of driving outcomes i mean when you look at the national data support staff have just ballooned while student enrollment's going so we have more and more and more and more support staff in our schools

[07:39:38] than we've had in a long time i mean i can surprise supply those data for you i'm not saying that you know they don't they're not needed but i'm just saying for an umbrella statement like let's just take off the cap like let's have a more nuanced conversation about which types we think drive outcomes and then we actually need more of as opposed to like everybody from the you know the kitchen lady the janitor the bus you know it's just a huge category um that that really covers too much ground i think to have a meaningful conversation about where we think we need more fewer and less of and and i do think that that speaks that comment speaks directly to what mr

[07:40:16] hansen was saying earlier today rather than giving a big pot of money let's look at it in those places that are going to be most impactful and how we can support with resources those items that are going to truly impact outcomes mr rotherham yes i have two concerns of the direction we're going and one maybe is a little different than what you just suggested um so what is just the laundry list problem i do worry we get back we have a bunch of stuff and then they take a few and are like we we did when we've actually got some big meaty recommendations and and i want to we've talked about that i i do want to be sensitive to that because i think there's some

[07:40:55] there's some meaty stuff the second thing is i take the point that we're underfunding and so forth i think that is correct but doing that through what we can through the at-risk add-on which we've agreed to today doing that through flexible funding seems like i worry that this sort of piecemeal way of getting there which we think you need this resource or that resource like you can do those things with the with the larger so i actually do think and i disagree somewhat with my colleague mr hansen's i think you

know i agree on some aspects of education spending we probably disagree on some um i'm comfortable with those bigger i would hope that the assembly would take those recommendations and be ambitious with them but do it the way of flexibility i'm worried we're

[07:41:34] sort of just getting right back into nickel and diming and then that's why i hope all this will uh include all these things are transition it just like our conversation on on using our credit agencies for accountability we're using like a rickety old architecture to try to do 2023 things as my colleague said recently and so i think we should be very clear these are transitional recommendations these big pots of money that we're suggesting and this all has to get wrapped and do some serious work to get to a new finance system any other comments i think we had a motion

[07:42:09] and a second on the support stack staff cap removal so we've had discussion is there anything else that you all would like to hear from mr dickey about as it relates to this particular motion okay so this motion is to um add into our soq prescriptions the elimination of support staff

[07:42:33] Kat. Ms. Holton, how do you vote? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Ms. Ashton? No. Dr. Northern? No. Mr. Stardefine? No. Mr. Rotherham? No. Mr. Hanson? No. And chair votes no. Okay. And then we had one more issue.

[07:42:56] So I will move that we add a prescription, add language to our standards of quality prescriptions, that we substitute the division averages for prevailing costs rather than the current linear weighted average formula.

[07:43:14] And I will defer to Mr. Dickey to explain that further, but my motion is pursuant, consistent with the JLARC recommendation. Can you repeat that? I'm going to use the JLA language, that we calculate prevailing costs using the division average rather than the current formula's linear weighted average.

[07:43:38] Okay. All right. So I believe as we started having a discussion on this, well, I'll wait for a second. Yeah, I really want to hear Kent's explanation. But I, without, without, so you seconded it so that we could, okay, so the board wanted a little bit more of an explanation to inform decision making, please.

[07:44:01] Yeah, sure. And so it's really technical. I don't have any cost impact because we've just run that, but all unit cost in the standards of quality, whether it's funded salaries, and that's what most people look at and refer to on the linear weight average, and that was a focus in the JLARC report because it's such a major cost driver.

[07:44:27] but there are other components that essentially follow the same type of weighted average calculation, but instead of what we would think of as a regular average, you know, taking all the teacher salaries statewide, dividing them by the FTE teachers, I mean, that's a gross statewide average. That is not the average methodology that's used in the SOQ, and that same principle would follow with non-personal costs that are funded for materials and supplies and

[07:45:06] utilities and things that are in the support realm. Those aren't based on a gross statewide average. And so that same principle applies there as well. Support staff salaries also. So Underlying the SOQ historically is not the traditional statewide average, which does tend to drive higher cost because the averages tend to skew upward for the higher spenders.

[07:45:38] But it is a weighted average methodology. All of, you know, all of the data points, you know, district wide or district by district are lined up, whether that's, you know, materials and supplies, costs per

pupil, elementary teachers, whatever the cost is that's funded.

[07:46:01] each data point by division is used for the average. So Lee County's data point has as much weight as Fairfax or a large school division. And then a second layer of the weighted average comes in where those division data points, whether it's non-personal costs for material supplies or a salary average,

[07:46:32] Those that are closest to the median are weighted the highest, and the outlying values are weighted one on a sort of declining basis. And so that's the original JLARC principle of 35 years ago that the state should recognize cost, whether it's funded salaries or other elements in the formula, where most school divisions are spending and clustering around the middle or the median.

[07:47:05] And so all of those adjustments are involved in the calculation, the SOQ. It's never deviated from that approach, but a traditional gross statewide average does tend inevitably to drive higher cost just because of the nature of the mathematical differences in the calculations.

[07:47:34] And Jim Mark, you know, had had, you know, a good bit of discussion in their July report on that president. Yes, ma'am. And if I'm if I may, Mr. Dickey, am I right that essentially what we're talking about here is still what proportion if we put something in the SOQ, then the state is funding a larger share would be required to fund a larger share of the costs.

[07:48:00] But we're not really talking about, if we pass this SOQ, we're not talking about people get raises anywhere. We're just talking about how much of that money is paid by the state versus the localities. And that's why the localities uniformly are supportive of this prescription.

[07:48:19] You're right. And changing that average methodology, whether it's, you know, funded, you know, salaries for the SOQ positions or other components, I mean, it's going to increase the total cost that's then going to be, you know, split by the state and the localities.

[07:48:37] So it's going to increase the cost of the funded standards in the formula that would increase state funding, but it is going to increase local share total cost increases because the locals are already paying so much beyond that would be why the localities generally are supportive for the majority that would be beyond that threshold.

[07:49:02] It just depends on how much, where they are now in their local budgets versus the cost increase of the formula if something like that was done. Madam President. Mr. Sertifan. What I heard, a piece of what I heard, is the possibility that it would increase the share that localities have to pay.

[07:49:20] For some, it may. For some. Okay, thank you. And would that be, that would be smaller school divisions that it would increase the impacts of, correct? Or is there a direction on that? Typically, yes. the school divisions that are closer to the spending minimums from local funds tend to be the smaller rural divisions with some exceptions. Thank you. Madam President, to the extent that's a major consideration, we might want to move this forward for further consideration next month and

[07:49:52] then talk to our local divisions. Madam President, can I just clarify, the motion is to do a division average versus the linear weighted average can you just explain the division average how does did you already explain how that come yeah that's really just a traditional average you know teacher salaries instead of the you know the each division data point uh where you're really averaging an average in lee county's division average weighs as much as or you know counts as much as fairfax

[07:50:29] and then there's additional weighting if in the case of a funded teacher salary it would be dividing the total salary cost by all the teacher ftes in the state that would be a gross average i mean there are even other approaches um where you would you would um use each division data point for a division average salary but you wouldn't uh apply any further weights as as is done now to to recognize more of the median cost and and that would that would be an approach

[07:51:05] as well so there's um but what what most have analyzed through the years particularly again on teacher salaries is is that gross traditional you know arithmetic average of a teacher salary total total salary cost divided by number of teachers no no waiting gross statewide average that does tend to be the the most expensive outcome okay thank you any other comments on this motion before we formally vote mr rother just a question um so i i hear my colleagues i'm

[07:51:44] concerned about rural small rural districts as well and the potential impact we've also got a fiscal cliff coming um and you know we've been going over the you know the funds are obligated and being spent out should we how should we in terms of like the near term and you know i know know, the JLARC has the recommendations set up, so the near-term, long-term, which is near-term, how should we be thinking about that in relation to what could, sounds like for at least some divisions could be a little bit of a shock to the system if we did this. There's the potential for that, I think, and, you know, some divisions have, they've continued to grow their local budgets from local funds, but they've been, you know, they've been able to offset, you know, for several years,

[07:52:19] some local funding in their budgets with the pandemic funds, and so, you know, if their spending hasn't kept pace as it may have historically um that you know if that makes sense um because they've backfilled with with global funds now eventually of course you know pandemic funding is going to but um it it could be a challenge for some it just depends on the cost relative to what they're

[07:52:50] extending. Please. Mr. Rotherham's point, actually, I think the correct explanation here, there's the actual average, and then there's the statistically weighted average that comes in less. There's what it's really costing versus how we can calculate it and make it seem like it's less. That difference, again, if it was actually closed, would actually help with any funding cliffs, because it would be for a huge proportion of school divisions, the state paying for things, the state share for things

[07:53:25] that the local divisions are already paying for entirely thank you can that was good anything else on this okay so miss holton would you read the motion one more time please move that we direct the department to come back to us with language that would enable us to enact an soq prescription to calculate the prevailing costs using division average rather than linear weighted average

[07:53:58] as per the jlark report okay miss holton how do you vote aye dr siebert hi miss ashton no dr norther no mr sturdifan nay mr rotherham if i understand the motion they're just coming back hi i'm not voting to adopt hi okay mr hanson and chair votes now okay um now thank you mr dickey

[07:54:31] sorry we had to call you back in um is there anything else before we move on i'm moving on hearing none really quickly and we are going to pivot to item h please i'm so sorry you all have been waiting in the wings back there for as long as you have but i appreciate your patience and thank you thank you all for your time and good afternoon everyone president creasy superintendent

[07:55:09] coons and fellow board members my name is dr anthony williams i'm the director of the office of career technical and adult education i have with me miss kelly davis who is our curriculum and

instruction coordinator not dr armstrong but we're going to we're going to proceed as planned all right just want to share uh some brief notes with you all uh regarding our proposal for programmatic accreditation guidelines for cte so we provided uh these guidelines and that are in in front of you for your approval. According to 22.1-227.01, career and technical education

[07:55:48] is defined as an organized education program offering a sequence of courses that may incorporate field, laboratory, or classroom instruction, emphasize career and technical occupational experiences, and are designed to prepare individuals for further education and gainful employment, and are aligned to state or national program certification and accreditation standards if such standards exist for the sequence of courses.

[07:56:14] The purpose of this guidance document is to establish state accreditation standards. The proposed guidelines will continue to ensure a high level of quality while removing barriers and providing access for our students throughout the Commonwealth.

[07:56:31] The alignment process for state accreditation standards includes guidance for planning, implementing, monitoring of CT programs, industry-validated course competencies, equipment, and standards applicable to state and federal regulations related to health and safety.

[07:56:48] CTE courses and programs with national programmatic accreditation requirements impacted by this guidance include graphic imaging technology, small engine technology, culinary arts, pharmacy technician, and HVAC.

[07:57:07] We have received feedback from various industry partners to include the Virginia Board of Pharmacy and the Virginia Restaurant, Lodging, and Travel Association, as mentioned by Mr. Terry earlier today, as well as a number of school divisions and CTE teachers to include teachers and administrators.

[07:57:30] So circling back, it is our recommendation, the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education waive first review and approve the programmatic accreditation guidelines as outlined in front. Do you all have any questions?

[07:57:44] Questions from the board. Ms. Holton. I have two. Thank you. Thank you, especially for your patience. The concern that was raised by Mr. Terry, I don't purport to understand the ins and outs here, but I thought I understood him to be asking that we put a pause on these, meaning that we vote, that we not accept these guidelines today.

[07:58:12] Is that what your understanding of his position is, or is it the opposite? And if that is his position, can you tell me what our answer, your answer is? That's correct. So what Mr. Terry is mentioning is that right now there's a national programmatic accreditation requirement specifically for culinary arts that requires CTE courses and programs to be accredited under the ACF.

[07:58:33] That requirement is leading to a number of barriers within our school divisions. As mentioned, equipment requirements, accreditation requirements, you have the initial payment requirements, as well as renewal and annual payment requirements that can lead to thousands of dollars per year.

[07:58:54] Many of these costs are absorbed through our Perkins funding, but this is funding that can be reallocated and used in better ways. So with our state accreditation standards, this will provide relief and flexibility. so you're giving him more flexibility so it should make him happy from the field thank you that's

what i need any other questions okay hearing none can i get a motion to waive first review and approve the programmatic accreditation guidelines for career

[07:59:29] and technical education as presented in this item second miss holton hi dr siebert hi miss ashton Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. Mr. Hanson. Aye. And chair votes aye. Thank you so much. Thank you all. Okay. Dr. Coons, I think that's you. And then Dr. Armstrong. Is that a written report?

[08:00:00] So I'm really happy to give our regular special education report. We have a couple of updates. The OSEP team did their final evaluation in September.

[08:00:20] They have actually recommended to two other states to consider the prioritized monitoring program that our team presented in September. So we are starting to get good feedback from that monitoring visit. on our prioritized monitoring. I will say that the prioritized monitoring was part of the conversation that we have with some of the prescriptions, but it is also one of the focal areas of the two special education reports. I want to thank Ms. Holton. I was under the assumption that you all received those. We will make sure that everyone has those special education reports. Our special education work group has had those reports for several weeks. They are

[08:00:58] reviewing those. And then we will start to dig in for the roadmap to during our meeting after Thanksgiving. Huge shout out to several of our superintendents who are serving on that. Also, Ms. Holton, you asked that we would make sure we had a SSEAC member on that work group. We added that person on that work group to make sure we also added an educator who has a disability and a daughter with a disability to make sure that we had more representative parent voices and more solely represented parent voices that group is dedicated to at least a 12-month work

[08:01:38] group so we're excited about the work moving forward in those special education work groups i also want to provide an update on iTeach during the July board meeting Dr. Northern you asked us to work closely with iTeach to improve their content. Given where we were in the review of our special education department, we wanted to make sure that we sought outside assistance.

[08:02:02] We went to CSEP, which is the Southern Southeastern Cooperative Education Program. They are well recognized and respected in the state for the special education work they do. They formed a review committee and the letter in your packet and the letter you received We have a mail and the letter that will be posted is posted on our special education website walks through their review of the qualifications, the references that they used in that review, the process they used and the findings.

[08:02:31] You will also see the letter that I sent back to the department saying they would be in compliance with all recommendations from CSEP and they would have those no later than the end of this month in November. then once they have those we will move forward with i teach on special education based on the guidance of the board um that that is our special education report this month thank you okay so we are now to our last item on the engines i believe we are at discussion of current items

[08:03:06] so where are we on that does anybody have something that they would like to discuss or share just want to provide a couple updates from the department if that's okay before we get started um the chronic absenteeism task force the statewide task force um that the governor asked us to create in the fall and all in virginia has met twice they met the first meeting on transportation and they met the second meeting on parent engagement given its parent engagement month that was really appropriate one of the

things that the task force has asked us to do is the conversations are so rich and dynamic they asked us to record the parts of the conversation and the

[08:03:44] content and then create discussion guides so that school division teams could use those and replicate their own conversations and their own thought partnership so we have done those for the first two meetings and we'll continue to do that so that the con the content the first content we had national experts on transportation they provided a great deal of flexible tools and walked through how school divisions could use those so that discussion guide was posted last week we had attendance works out of john hopkins university talk about a variety of different parent engagement strategies um similar to mtss what should you do for all parents what

[08:04:21] should you do for those parents who are struggling at that chronic absenteeism rate what are you doing with parents who have persistent issues so we had a lot of conversation about around those tools and creating a comprehensive plan lots of resources for school divisions to use and then we We also had a model from Louisa County and then legislation that was conversation that Keith Perrigan proposed for some of those perpetual situations.

[08:04:47] So it was a really great meeting. I encourage you to watch those videos. We've had a lot of great feedback from school divisions around the support. And I'm just so impressed with our school divisions, the videos, the campaigns, the amount of work they're doing on attendance is just very impressive.

[08:05:04] And a few hats off to this board for holding the line last spring around attendance, because that is really part of the impetus that has helped us really focus on this and dig in. We talked about literacy today. Very excited about the literacy. We had a BAS presentation, and I think we were in a breakout, but no one else went to any other breakout.

[08:05:24] So it might have been a real BAS. It might have been a whole session where we talked about what it meant to be a literacy superintendent. And Emily Solari talked about the district implementation framework. We outlined the number of resources we are providing school divisions, including an implementation framework and then a regional series where teams can get together and really start thinking about implementation.

[08:05:45] Like, what does this look like? What does it feel like? I'm excited that we're finally getting started. We probably should have done this 18 months ago, but really helping districts plan around what they want to do with literacy and what they need to do with literacy. how to best use reading specialists, how to think about the materials.

[08:06:02] The materials are not switching from a blue book to a green book. We are fundamentally changing instruction. What does that look like? How do we support principals? How do we support leaders? Really asking our superintendents to be literacy leaders and lead this work, because ultimately they set the vision.

[08:06:19] And if they set the vision to be the literacy superintendent and the literacy leader in their school division, big change is going to happen. So that was a great opportunity. We have 91 of our all-in spending plans from our school divisions reported and transparently on the website. We are super proud of our school divisions.

[08:06:36] They're working very hard. We had a visit to Bunkingham County last week. They all had all-in t-shirts, but the best part of it was there were kiddos being tutored. And just like we had kiddos talk about

the Cumberland County Elementary Milliken Award winner, they were talking about what they were getting out of all-in and how much it helping them and how excited it was so it was really exciting to hear students talk about the work that the school divisions are doing and to see 70 of our school divisions really rocking and rolling was just really exciting so i just wanted to give you that um we are confirmed for december

[08:07:13] 11th in chesterfield our board has has confirmed that so really appreciate that all of those um accountability and accreditation listening sessions are town hall posted they will also be posted on the board website memos have gone out to school divisions several school divisions have asked to partner with us around regional communications to make sure we're getting as many people to those meetings as possible so just wanted to give you a couple quick updates on the priorities of the agency and where we are and appreciate the support of the board today i think it's really helpful and the directionality was super helpful in helping us make sure we can

[08:07:49] continue the work and supporting the board in their work other comments madam president um i I think the presentation today was great with PANS and PANDAS. I wasn't that familiar with it. And if it's possible after it's reviewed, is this something that can be sent out to all school divisions so that the nurses can review it?

[08:08:12] I would just say that generally speaking, you know, our school nurses do have the ability to receive that information. We have a really good school nurses group that is very well informed.

[08:08:28] I'm happy to communicate with Tracy White and just say, can y'all do, and in fact, I would make a suggestion that we ask them to do maybe special sessions on autoimmune diseases like PANS and PANDAS, because there are so many more that our kids are struggling with, and that they get diagnosed with in the time that they're living their lives in our schools.

[08:09:00] And it is so imperative that school nurses play an active role so that teachers are very understanding of how to support students both in the classroom and outside of the classroom and have the nurses be advocates for them as well while they're in school.

[08:09:18] they very well may already have this information but if they don't if we can partner or as it goes through the our system i'll make sure get this to them and also i think it's important as our boards we make these major decisions i think back when i was a school board member you were here some of my former superintendents or your school board members they would say about another mandate we got another mandate we have to find a way to fund this and i think it's important as we make these decisions we keep that in mind that every school division is not urban and there are still places

[08:09:55] in the commonwealth where kids have picked up on the dirt road and they don't have access to a lot of other schools no internet access no wi-fi no cell phone coverage to the point that some houses can't even get a regular phone line in because of that so um i enjoy working with the board as we get through these many issues that come up and we just keep doing the best we can that's all i have madam president thank you anyone else dr northern but just a few random thoughts um one i would just encourage you guys i you know i'd ask to get it printed and um and it's it's pretty wonky and dense i'll just give you that but the school district funding in virginia report is worth

[08:10:35] your time what i think you'll find really interesting is just jot this down page 11 if you go there they did an actual mapping um district by district and they have the amount that the local locals pay and

the state pays for each district which is fascinating just click on it wow it's eye-opening just to see how it changes across the districts um i don't think that's data that we know internally so um you know we've paid other contractors to actually figure it out for us and then it allows you to set like play with these little weights like what if we did this

[08:11:14] with the sales tax what if we you know moved it up move it down what if we did the what what if we made these changes on the composite index so it allows you to begin to see the ramifications of some of these funding decisions as we move forward and try to get smarter around this so it's it's hugely helpful and that way again even even if you just want to look at the local and state um share by each by each district so um i would keep this report um just so you have it as we continue moving forward with these discussions um and i guess just one thing on um dual enrollment i just heard something today that i just want us to keep in mind as we move forward with

[08:11:54] um you know college and career readiness i mean dual enrollment was meant to be you know you get credit for taking these college courses for graduation. It's not meant to be the other way around, right? It's not meant to be you take these high school courses and then you get college credit. So I just want to make sure we're not going to, we're not watering down dual enrollment, you know, because there's always a tendency to sort of, oh, this is really exciting. Kids can get credit, but it's really important that we keep the rigor of those courses. In some cases, people are like oh it's like ap i'm like what's only like ap if you actually keep the rigor you

[08:12:30] know who's teaching the courses or is it the not that you know the high school teachers can teach the courses but obviously they would need to have additional training to meet the rigor of the college course so um just a heads up that we just want to be careful as we um look at dual enrollment and i think the the last piece oh was these um uh listening sessions coming up i just want to to make sure that whatever we have i mean i'm doing three of them soon um what we're presenting to them is it going to be slides like like here are the things that we talked about in the board meeting react to this is it going to be questions like how are these listing sessions going to be

[08:13:06] structured so we get really good feedback okay and additionally just like a chart of who's going where that'd be great anything else mr rotherham i have two items one that's my first commend dr I mean, that readout we just got on sort of what's going on, I feel like we're like really hitting our stride right now.

[08:13:27] There's a lot happening and we're addressing a lot. And it's exciting to see on a range of things. And I'm actually optimistic that over the next year with the SOQ and so forth, there's opportunities for some pretty substantial change to some of the ways we do things in Virginia, not just what we're talking about, accountability, but on finance and so forth.

[08:13:47] I wanted to call that out. That's one of the best updates since I've been on this board in terms of this board momentum. So I wanted to call that out. I also do want to raise a point on public comment. I don't know how other board members feel. I haven't talked to anyone except to you, Madam President, but I do feel strongly we should have public comment at the beginning of board meetings, just full stop, at least on agenda items.

[08:14:14] i'm open and i'm gonna offer a solution i'm open to some some ideas we want to do general comment afterwards we got lucky that the gentleman who wanted to talk about cte that you know we didn't get to that agenda item and so forth so that one worked out but that would have been that would have been a miss um i just feel like look it's a first amendment uh activity it's an important one it was

virginians i will know who came up with that amendment um and it's first for a reason and it's important it's important that we do it in a way that that's responsive engages um with stakeholders with parents and so forth so i would like to uh if

[08:14:50] it's the will of the board uh direct the uh the state superintendent capacity secretary to come back with some recommendations on how we can do this going forward to make sure we don't have a situation where we're if we're bifurcating it for any reason we're not giving people a chance to to comment on actual agenda items at a minimum and just think about that.

[08:15:10] I worry we're moving to uncharted territory and to chart. I'm happy to offer a formal or we can, but to come back with recommendations on how we do that, because I do think we want it, that is something, especially if we're going to have special meetings, we're going to have, you know, this meeting got cut to one day and so forth, that is something I think we need to be extremely attentive to.

[08:15:32] i i do think on um well let me just say that that has been something that i as president have been discussing with our ag council um additionally i've been discussing with the superintendent just did different ideas and iterations of opportunities that may exist and at the end of the day i think we're going to have to take a look at what our bylaws say and how we can make any changes within those if we so desire to but um we appreciate the comments and moving forward, we'll certainly make sure that we have some opportunities for options. It may not be at

[08:16:09] our December 13th or 12th meeting, but perhaps in our meetings when the new year comes, we'll be looking at those opportunities. Madam President, that's a special meeting. Are we planning to take public comment? No, not at a special meeting. I wasn't. As a special meeting, I didn't think so.

[08:16:29] As to the agenda items, I mean, we're making final votes on the comprehensive plan and the SOQ recommendations and annual report. Am I right? All three of those are on for a final vote in December.

[08:16:45] I think we should allow public comment. Those are really important things. I mean, you know, we've had public submit letters. Okay. Well, we don't, if we don't have any cases. Okay. So, yes. is that because it's a special meeting and our Bible is just revisions there can we then limit public comment to those agenda items yes I mean I mean we might look at that first but I think this might be an opportunity to pilot uh the idea because I I like the idea of people speaking agenda items I used to never mind because it's a special meeting we don't have

[08:17:18] to have public comment right if we if we allow public comment can we say it's it's only subject to the agenda items yeah i think i think you can it's threading the middle in a new way i would think since it's a special medium it would make a lot of sense to implement it to the items on the agenda it's a general meeting that's maybe not agreed okay deb if you find anything that says

[08:17:52] otherwise so we will accommodate public comment on the agenda items alone if that's sufficient is that okay works for me okay just want to make sure we should remind people about the president all the other ways besides physically coming here that there are to contribute and you can and we got some really excellent letters an excellent letter from a student this um uh and and so there are other ways to to communicate with us yes thank you any other comments i i miss holton

[08:18:28] dr coons you and i spoke you said i know you have been focused since you came on this uh that issue of backlogs with our teacher licensure, and you had attempted to accelerate the automation of that

system, but run into some snags. Can you update us on the automation of the licensure system?

[08:18:47] Yep, really appreciate the reminder. We actually had contracted with a vendor prior to my arrival in working through with the vendor in the summer. The vendor had committed in their contracting that they would meet certain teacher security provisions. As that was rolled out, the provisions could not be met, so they had to go back to the table and get a new contractor. We were on track to release in October. There are credit card verifications that occurred yesterday in end-to-end testing that went through. I think today, my understanding is they're running one more set

[08:19:27] of tests. So with all due respect, I want to make sure that those protections are in place, but I would expect that to be up and running in the next several days. But I also want to make sure I'm not making a commitment to that without making sure that we have the ultimate protections on data security for our teachers and data security for credit card verification, because we don't want to release a system in today's day and age that isn't completely secure.

[08:19:55] So while the system, the back end pieces of the system are running, we want to make sure the security pieces meet the expectations. And many of you know, VITA has some of the best security expectations in the country, and we appreciate those most days. But we also want to adhere to all of those expectations.

[08:20:12] And we weren't quite there with the original vendor. And now our credit card company for all government agencies is making sure that it's not a DOE credit card procurement process. It is a statewide procurement of credit card verification. And they are going through that statewide process to make sure that all protections possible are in place for our educators.

[08:20:36] And I want to make sure those are in place. I would love for the system to be up, but most importantly, we have to make sure we're secure. So thank you for reminding me. Anything else? Well, I would just like to thank you all for an efficient meeting, and we are adjourned.

